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Virginia Board of Education, Standards of Quality Session, Wednesday, July 21, 2021

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G1Wbk7TDZGg
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:05:06] - All right, I make it to be one o'clock. Welcome everybody to the Standards of Quality Committee meeting. As you know, all of you know, the SOQs are part of our constitutional obligation as a board. Been very happy the last couple of years that the board has taken that obligation seriously and following a fair amount of research, gone ahead and prescribed SOQs.

[00:05:31] We have had, I guess, limited success in the General Assembly so far, but I think we keep at this long enough, you know, eventually we will see the concepts that we want embedded in, you know, the state adopted SOQs, you know, coming from our work.

[00:05:51] First item is approval of minutes from the June 16, 2021 committee meeting. Has everybody had an opportunity to read the minutes? And if so, is there a motion either to adopt them or to suggest changes?

[00:06:07] - President Gecker, I'll move to adopt the minutes. - Thank you, Dr. Wilson, is there a second? - Second. - Thank you, Dr. Robertson. All those in favor, signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Any opposed? Yes. Oh, okay.

[00:06:22] That's fine. Although, as you know, Robert's Rule says, even if you're not there, you're entitled to vote on them. There you go. Fair enough. Let's move on then. We are delighted to have with us Dr. Sale,

Director of Policy, to sort of bring us up to date and where we've been, and perhaps a look at where we might be going.

[00:06:51] Dr. Sayle, good afternoon. - This is my first time presenting in this room, so bear with me on technical difficulties, learning all the buttons I need to push.

[00:07:06] - That's right, all of us forgot what it was like to be here. We had a pretty rocky morning also.

[00:07:33] - Okay, that looks and sounds a little bit better here. So look to Tim to see if the presentation will get pulled up for you so you can follow along. - I'm bringing it up, sorry. - Oh, no problem.

[00:07:53] - All right, wonderful. Well, thank you, President Gecker, members of the board and Dr. Lane. It is my pleasure to be back in front of you all today to continue the conversation that we started last month with the SOQ review committee.

[00:08:08] Just very quickly to touch on what we're gonna cover today, again, really an extension of the items that we talked about last time, last month, and wanted to build from the conversations and discussions that we had to start focusing in on how we might continue to move forward on those items that came from the 2019 and 2020 reviews of the SOQ.

[00:08:32] And what we'll do today, or a critical mass of what we'll do today is spend a little time going back through those 2019 and 2020 revisions. And I apologize for some of the redundancy from the last presentation, but I think it's a useful exercise for us. And start to look at the deltas that we've seen since the General Assembly has taken some action on a few of the prescriptions, but we haven't yet seen any of the prescriptions fully realized.

[00:08:57] And so there's still an opportunity for you as a board to continue to push and find momentum and where we've seen some changes happen to get us all the way to full realization and then promote some action in places where we haven't seen as many gains or any gains at all.

[00:09:13] And with that part of the presentation, we'll also look at some of the updated numbers. So since the General Assembly has taken an action in a few of those spaces, we will see the cost associated some of those prescriptions have also changed and then of course over the last two years there has been a good number of other other committees and folks as well as an agency that have kind of inspired some ways for us to think about what work we might be doing or other work that we might consider in the SOQ space so taking a look at what has come from those discussions and what might

[00:09:51] inform or lend itself to any new prescriptions whether that be in this cycle or in future cycles and i will pause there very quickly to see if i'm okay to continue going without my microphone here i think we need my new batteries okay all right they're coming been in this room apparently in 18 months even though we did a test run yesterday

[00:10:22] okay so we will continue on here again um reflecting on the work that you all did in 2019

[00:11:03] and re-prescribed in 2020 um looking at where we started and where we are today just a quick refresher on a few of the things that have come from general assembly action in the last two years as you will remember from the last presentation during our june board meeting we took a broader look at a lot of the actions to come from the general assembly that touched on the standards of quality in any way shape or form but the ones that we have up here are really corollaries of the board's prescriptions so these are more directly tied to the items and prescriptions and proposals you put forward in this space so you will

see this list is a little bit more abbreviated than the one we covered last month just a quick refresher we had several pieces

[00:11:43] of legislation that updated ratios during our 2020 general assembly session one of them related to our el teachers and the second related to our school counselors both of them had kind of interim phases of implementation but i think what's important for us to know in the coming school year the 21-22 school year the expectation for school divisions is to staff at a 20 to a thousand student ratio for our EL teachers um and that is not distinguished based on proficiency level and then for our school counselors we will be at one full-time school counselor per 325 students

[00:12:19] additionally during the 2020 general assembly session we also saw some movement in the at-risk add-on space and this is a component of the larger equity fund proposal that you all put forward again we didn't see the equity fund fully realized but we did see more money dedicated to the at-risk add-on program so for those divisions and those schools serving larger populations of higher poverty students the scaled amount or the additional per pupil amount added on to their funding was scaled a little bit differently and they were eligible for more funding so pretty pretty significant and

[00:12:54] meaningful gain in that space in 2020 then in 2021 Senate bill 1257 got us part of the way on the specialized student support personnel positions if If you'll recall, your proposal was four for every 1,000 students, and they did propose and pass a bill that would require three full-time positions for every 1,000 students.

[00:13:16] And the specialized student support personnel position does create a new category that pulls certain positions out of the support cap. And of course, happy to revisit that with you all if you'd like a refresher. But just as a quick reminder, those support positions include school nurses, school psychologists, social workers, and other health and behavioral license personnel.

[00:13:38] Lastly, we also saw the General Assembly take action on a board's recommendation. So since this was a budgetary item, this wasn't listed as part of a prescription, but it's something that you saw as important for complementing the work that we do with the SOQ.

[00:13:54] And this was removing the SOQ staffing flexibility that had been put in place during the recession in 2009, giving divisions a little bit more space on how they were hiring in certain SOQ staffing areas. But in the second year of the budget, that flexibility is removed, so those staffing requirements that are set out in standard two of the standards of quality are now the expectation for the school divisions moving into the 21-22 school year.

[00:14:24] So again, looking at that and starting with where we are now as our baseline for this next phase of the conversation, we know that all of the prescriptions that you all put forth are still important and would like to see them fully realized, but how can we continue to think about those and move them forward um in this next review cycle or this review cycle rather and continue promoting some action and important spaces so in the next few slides what staff did to help that conversation and and really start the discussion on how we might do additional promotion in the standards of quality prescription space is started to kind of refocus and reframe

[00:15:02] the order in which we we put forth our prescriptions and i know this slide here talks about kind of prioritization um and i know a i might even use the word prioritization um but i really think that's probably a bit of a misnomer and and what we're doing here because these are certainly all priorities for

the board they're indicative of a lot of research and a lot of stakeholder feedback so these are evidence-based prescriptions so we know that what you would put forward is all important work and all high priority but it's really kind of refocusing to make sure again where we didn't see as many gains the board is communicating some of the spaces in which we might

[00:15:42] want to see the general assembly take additional action so with that you'll again these proposals all look similar or actually identical to what you would put forth in 2019 and 2020 but they're reorganized in terms of how we have them listed you will also see as the added column there on the far right is an updated cost amount and again this reflects some of the the action that we've already seen from the general assembly as well as just changes and and some salary costs and estimates that go into to these numbers over the last two years so the first one here we have

[00:16:22] the equity funds still at the top of the list um and this is really even though we have seen some changes with the expansion of the at-risk add-on program um that this is a high impact area and has the potential um to really make a difference in in school divisions and how they're serving their higher poverty students so again we still have a ways to go before full realization with the delta there of 77 million before we saw the equity fund being fully funded and again this being a high impact area keeping this at the top of the list the next two items and places where we haven't seen any action from the general assembly are the teacher leader and teacher

[00:17:01] mentor programs and the principal mentorship program these are really indicative of the board's focus and emphasis on making sure that we're supporting our teachers as a tool for both recruitment and retention so making the the school environment feel feel one that's welcoming and has more of a call for folks who want to serve in the the school environment and then providing them the support they need to really grow into to quality instructors and keep them keep them in the building and provide quality work environments for them the next one is our work-based learning coordinators And this is really in alignment with the profile of a Virginia graduate.

[00:17:38] And again, something that we haven't seen much movement on or traction with during the general assembly sessions. I will just quickly call your attention to the difference, a small kind of marginal cost increase between the last time these were prescribed and the estimate that you see in the far right column.

[00:17:55] So for the teacher leader and teacher mentor program, since these are salaried positions with the school division, that compensation adjustment that happened during the last general assembly session is reflected in this new estimate here since these salaries would also be increased as part of this.

[00:18:11] And then for the principal mentorship and work-based learning coordinators, these are both state-based positions since they require regional and statewide coordination. And those small marginal increased costs for them are technology costs for supporting and providing what they need to do their work at the state level.

[00:18:33] Our next several proposals, again, are spaces where we have not seen general assembly action or have not seen the full action that we would like to see from the General Assembly. The first two proposals are staffing at the leadership level and school leadership level with assistant principals and elementary school principals.

[00:18:51] Again, these are items that we haven't seen any action on in the General Assembly space. And as you recall, the assistant principal prescription is actually something that has been on the board's wish list for a good number of years. So hence why we elevated that to higher on the list as we continue to talk about this round of prescriptions.

[00:19:10] For the English learner teachers, as I noted, we have seen some changes and updates to the ratios. So we moved from 17 full-time positions per 1,000 students to 20 in the upcoming year, which is a meaningful shift.

[00:19:28] But a large part of the board's prescription in this space was making sure that staffing was differentiated based on proficiency level for students. making sure those students who really had more ground to make up had the right support and staffing in the in the classroom with them so for that reason even though again we have seen some traction there making sure that this stays high on our list breeding specialists again this is a space that we haven't seen much in the way of general assembly action there has been work done in terms of what intervention and prevention prevention intervention and remediation programs look like but there hasn't been any requirements for staffing in that space as a quick note for

[00:20:06] For those three items that we haven't seen any movement on, the assistant principals, elementary, and reading specialists to explain why there is a small differential in cost there. This is reflective of the drop in enrollment that we have seen post-pandemic, so these estimates may change real-time as enrollment goes back up and in-person instruction modalities come back online this fall, but of course the estimates did reflect some of that drop in enrollment that we have seen over the last year.

[00:20:35] And lastly here, we have the K3 class size reduction as one of our lower on the list of prescriptions. Again, not indicative of the importance of the program, but something that doesn't require a state impact and hasn't been as high impact area that the board might want to see.

[00:20:57] And then the specialized student support personnel positions and school counselors are ones that we have seen movement on the ratios. And so again, while there's a little ways to go to fully realize these prescriptions, we really would like to see some additional movement in those places where the General Assembly hasn't taken action.

[00:21:20] So as I noted in 2021, we did see one of the board's recommendations come to fruition in the budget, which was removing that SOQ staffing flexibility. The board had put forth another recommendation for budget language relating to the support cap.

[00:21:36] We have seen some adjustments in what the support cap position looks like in the budget since we did create the new specialized student support position but there is still a cap in place so for those other positions that are no longer captured in that new personnel category there are some limitations on how that funding is allocated to divisions so this is still a recommendation that you may consider moving forward with again this year since we haven't seen any change in that space and for that reason we did provide an updated estimated cost on what continuing with that recommendation would look like and that is going to be three hundred and seventy one point six million annually when trans or excuse me

[00:22:15] it was formally three hundred and seventy one point six million million as part of the 2019 and 2020 prescriptions but the updated estimate is now at three hundred and seventy three point five million so as I noted before that was kind of a big part of the discussion that we wanted to facilitate here today with you all and we will certainly come back to kind of talk through the the logic and the reasoning for

some of our ordering and and have you all reflect on on how we've kind of, like I said, refocused and reemphasized some of the prescriptions there.

[00:22:48] But based on the discussion last month, you had also requested us to think about some of the other work and feedback and input we've gotten from stakeholders, commissions, work groups, reports from JLARC, and think about how they might inform some new prescriptions for us.

[00:23:05] And as staff kind of reflected on that work, most of the time we found that many of the prescriptions that are many of the things that might lend itself for prescriptions didn't have an immediate need and didn't really meet that threshold of being evidence-based. So there were some spaces that we might see and continue to consider in future cycles, but we really didn't have the data, information, or time to evaluate the input, unanticipated consequences, and really have a complete picture to feel confident putting forth recommendations for new prescriptions during this cycle but some things we might keep an eye on for future review cycles based on feedback

[00:23:42] input and some of the things that have come from our conversations over the last two years one of the recommendations from the jlark report was to have us reflect on our school improvement plan and our office of school quality is currently working on that which will be brought back to the board for you all to hear and evaluate and learn more about what that plan looks like right now because that work is underway and that plan is still in development It may require some additional staffing that might be a way that we encourage some different staffing at the division level to support continuous improvement and school improvement work.

[00:24:16] But at this moment, as we develop that plan, didn't want to offer anything prematurely in this review cycle since much of the work in the space is already underway and will really inform our conversation moving forward. And then the next item I wanted to highlight for you all, because this was actually an error of mine from the last presentation and highlighting one of the recommendations to come from the African American Superintendents Advisory Council that I had mistakenly forgotten to transpose from their recommendation letter, so we didn't have an opportunity to talk about this last time.

[00:24:48] So I wanted to highlight that one of their recommendations that could potentially impact the standards of quality here is requiring one full-time position for a culturally competent and inclusive practices coordinator in every division. We did go ahead and get an estimate for this, just so we have all of the information as as we start the discussion today, which is based on the full-time salary of an assistant principal, 'cause we saw this individual potentially playing an instructional leadership role, and while it would be at the division level and not the school level, we saw many of the responsibilities looking largely analogous, so that's where we looked to base our estimate from.

[00:25:27] But as you all know, there's a lot of work already underway, and through the Culturally Competent Educators Workforce Bill, the trainings that will come online, And so what we might need or want from this role might be evolving as those pieces come together. And so taking into consideration, again, work being underway in this space, that this might be something that we look at for future review cycles to really evaluate the need at the division level and evaluate what type of role this person would play.

[00:25:59] And there were a few items that the board had indicated were certainly things that they wanted to consider for future review cycles, but because of the scale of the work that would come alongside these,

what we felt was the best kind of action plan moving forward was just to build out what our work plan and schedule for evaluating and taking a look at some of these topics would be.

[00:26:19] So with that, in September, 2021, we plan to bring back a presentation for you all around school construction and school facilities. We know school modernization and school facilities is a topic that you all wanted to take a closer look at to see if the standards of quality might be the appropriate place to address that topic.

[00:26:37] And we do have staff queued up and prepared to talk about what we currently have for school divisions, which is a guidelines document, talk about how facilities are currently funded and provide an overview of where we are on current school building conditions.

[00:26:53] And then the next item was special education staffing. And so with all of the work happening in response to the JLARC recommendation that their team and Dr. Samantha's Holland's team is getting prepared to be able to provide you all a work plan and an update on what some upcoming presentations would look like and get feedback for what would be meaningful and helpful for you all as we consider this as a topic to tackle in the next review cycles.

[00:27:21] And then the last item just to quickly address for you all, instructional technology resource teachers has been a topic to come up since the last review cycle, but again this year, excuse me.

[00:27:36] And this is one that we wanna continue to evaluate and we will have new staffing data available based on some new legislative requirements that we think will help us, excuse me, help inform us moving forward. So again, not delaying this one indefinitely, but wanting to make sure that you all have the information that you need to make an evidence-based prescription there.

[00:28:02] Excuse me. So with that, I will turn it back over to you all to begin. And I can address any questions you might have to start the conversation, but I'm letting you all take it from there. - Okay, well, thank you, Dr. Sale, for the presentation. Before I have the board, you know, chime in, I'd like to just say a few things.

[00:28:21] You know, it's clear, I guess it becomes increasingly clear to me when I see sort of the work of the board, you know, under the comp plan from 17 to 19 compressed into, you know, five or six or seven different bullet points with dollar signs attached, perhaps why we have not been as successful as we might like to be, you know, changing hearts and minds in terms of policy.

[00:28:46] You know, one of the, you know, and we have, you know, some newer folks on the board, you know, one of the things that we set out to do, and I think we're going to need staff's help to do this, is that as we talk about the changes, we also talk about the rationale for the changes.

[00:29:04] Because here, you know, and frankly, the reception we had at the assembly when, you know, went and lobbied or chatted with legislators was, tell me how much it costs instead of tell me what you want to do. And although everything we do has got dollars associated with it, really, I think, as a result of the research and work we did, as I said, from 17 to 19, you know, pre-prescription, you know, it could be boiled down to a few fairly simple concepts.

[00:29:37] You know, number one, that, you know, not all teachers teach, you know, as effectively at various points in their career. Number two, that throughout the Commonwealth, there is a allocation of teachers such that, in particular, younger teachers tend to be, you know, more inexperienced teachers or

teachers teaching outside their endorsed areas tend to be teaching in schools that have higher or, excuse me, a population with lower socioeconomics.

[00:30:07] The board, therefore, said, you know, gee, wouldn't it be great if we could incentivize the jurisdictions, because we certainly can't mandate it, but if we could incentivize the jurisdictions to have a better allocation, a more equitable allocation of teaching talent throughout their systems and, frankly, throughout the commonwealth.

[00:30:27] And thus was born, I guess, what gets shuffled into the no impact on the state, the K-3 class size reduction combined with the equity fund. The underlying concept there was to tell poorer jurisdictions in particular, or schools with a higher percentage of lower socioeconomic students, we're going to give you more money to go hire more experienced teachers.

[00:30:54] because right now we don't have a good way to measure effectiveness in the Commonwealth, although we continue to work toward that. And you're going to have a choice. You can either use that money to hire more, you know, experienced teachers and, you know, keep class sizes roughly where they are.

[00:31:11] Or if you're going to use more inexperienced teachers, you can use that money to reduce class size. That's sort of the underlying concept there. And honestly, you know, and this is not about how you did it. This is how we did it. you know the thought process behind that recommendation does not come through when it's stated in this way and i think it's important because you know that people understand you know everybody says well all they want to do is spend more money you know i read the press and the first thing that comes is you know board of education wants to spend an additional 800 800 million or

[00:31:48] an additional billion dollars when really it's not the money at that point what it is is we want to change the behavior on the ground we want to actually reshuffle the cards just a little bit to have better results overall and the money in part drives that for sure but it is not just saying we're going to throw more money and we want people to do exactly what they're doing today it's we want to change the actual behavior because we believe that the results will change if we can change behavior the second piece is we've had for as long as i've been on the board which isn't all

[00:32:26] all that long, really, you know, we talk about the teacher shortage. We talk about how difficult it is to retain, you know, up at UVA a couple of years ago, we saw the presentation, which basically said, you know, if you could improve your retention rates, you could actually eliminate the teacher shortage, right? I mean, we're losing so many teachers and typically you lose them, you know, years two, three, four, somewhere in there when the lack of support, you know, really just says to folks why am i doing this you know they they come to the job every day they do the best they

[00:32:57] can they don't get sufficient support uh their skill sets are not being proved you know by uh feedback dramatically and i know i've got superintendents here who might take some umbridge at this but overall you know not in arlington but everywhere else in the state we have you know issues and if you talk to you know my daughter you know didn't teach in virginia but she taught in California, you know, two years into teaching in San Diego, she said, I'm not going to do this anymore. You know, I just cannot get enough support. I've got friends, neighbors here, same kind of thing. You hear it enough to believe that it's true.

[00:33:33] The concept behind the mentorship was twofold. Number one, improve teaching skills, and number two, reduce the number of people leaving the profession with the goal of having our schools fully staffed and again it doesn't really come across to me as we read just the numbers that that's what we're looking to do and none of this as you know Leslie is criticism of this this is in fact how we have presented it for a couple years what I want is some help you know recrafting how we present so

[00:34:09] that people understand this is not about the dollars it is about the policy and finally I will say and then I'll you know ask the rest of the board for comments you know as we looked at the research and if you look at the you know comprehensive work plan item two it was teachers and building leadership you know principles clearly matter principles you know create the environment for teachers the strength of the principles clearly gets reflected in student outcomes which is what we're interested in long term

[00:34:46] You know, we need to be much more clear, I think, about why the principal mentorship program and, frankly, principal training is important to where we're headed. You know, I've said this a thousand times now in the last six years, all I really care about are student outcomes, right?

[00:35:07] I mean, at the end of the day, what we're looking to do here is drive better student outcomes. And how we reshape the system to do that is what this is about. And what the prescriptions, you know, what the SOQs at the board did were really 100% about doing those things that we think need to be done to improve student outcomes.

[00:35:28] You know, as I said, this is our constitutional obligation to prescribe. It is the General Assembly's constitutional right to trim. But I don't want another, I don't want to keep being in the cycle where the dollars get trimmed and the policy gets ignored.

[00:35:47] I would be okay with implementing policy even piecemeal, that is, you know, scaling it up. But to continue down the same path is what I would like to see us change as we move through. And that's about all I've got to say on this.

[00:36:05] So, anybody else? Dr. Wilson? I don't have anything to add necessarily to what you said, President Gecker, besides I do believe that the why is very important.

[00:36:26] behind the what we're asking for, to help people understand. So I appreciate that very much. Dr. Taylor, as you were going through the list, very helpful to see. Would you, and at the outset of the presentation, you were careful to, I guess, frame the idea that this, while we are using the term priority, it's not necessarily kind of a hard and fast priority.

[00:36:57] So I guess I'd like to hear a little bit more about, more about you explain as we've lined this out um what's the how do we want or as the as you and and other staff have put this together how did you want this to be viewed or receive this list you know kind of what's driving it as the reader what should we be looking what do are we looking at sure and and i guess maybe to start at you know i have the luxury of having a well-informed audience here today, so got to focus in on some of the weeds and the mechanics of what we're asking.

[00:37:31] But I certainly appreciate and hear the feedback about the importance of the why. So when we transmit this to the audience, who will hopefully help us carry this to the finish line, making sure that narrative component is there and very clear and very direct about the goals behind this and the vision behind this work.

[00:37:48] I think probably the best way to explain how we approached this and started to do that, I said not reprioritization work but reframing and refocusing work is to President Gecker's point about thinking about what spaces we might be able to drive some policy changes where we haven't already gotten momentum and and recognizing kind of evaluating again where those deltas exist and where we might be able to continue to move the needle and I think in that way that the General Assembly does often look to us to you know to evaluate what are the things that might have the most meaningful impact and concrete impact at the division level so if we did have to make those hard choices about which of

[00:38:27] these things we advance and carry forward where do we see the most most meaningful change happen so I think in that regard that's that's where our headspace was and that was kind of balancing where we have seen momentum versus impact and and where we might be able to provide some guidance and leadership you know to General Assembly members who do want to help carry this forward, but looking to get a sense of where we might do the most work, the quickest with the biggest impact, knowing that we still might be several General Assembly sessions away from fully realizing the SOQ prescriptions.

[00:39:02] And if I could follow up, so having heard your explanation, as I recall now, we have in past years been asked at some points if we had to choose where might we want to put our emphasis.

[00:39:19] So perhaps this is an attempt to start there. Right. Got it. Thank you. Yep. Precisely. I think it's just giving them more resources and tools to hopefully have them carry this forward and start to chip away at the things that we know will have the biggest impact.

[00:39:36] Again, not suggesting that all of these things aren't important and we don't want to see a motion in all of these spaces, but, you know, giving some direction to where we start of the process or continue the process rather since we have gotten some headway.

[00:39:52] - Yeah, Dr. Mann. - I'm sorry, Francesca. - Thank you so much. Hearing that made me wonder about what can we do that would have the biggest impact based on the momentum that we are experiencing.

[00:40:14] Makes me wonder if we were thinking about the context of what children are returning to coming out of this historic thing we have just lived. Do you, would you say that there might be other ways to think about, and I'll put priorities in quotes because I very much appreciate all that's been said about it all mattering, just as you said in your own comments.

[00:40:44] And I can't help but think about the youngest children and the challenges children, particularly our elementary children have experienced and just wonder myself about you know this list and thinking about that group if we have to think about what is their traction around that could have a really big impact so i don't have an answer for that but i'm certainly thinking about that as we're having this conversation um just given um what what i

[00:41:20] have heard and and i am understanding about the situation that very young children are face with having lived through the pandemic so i just offer that just a follow-up question on the english learner and action that was taken and was there and maybe it's connected to the why as well conversation was there any feedback in terms of why they didn't choose the additional um recommendation around by level is there something more we could have provided in the why and differentiating why that is so critical or do you have any comment on that unfortunately don't have

[00:41:57] have any context on why the proficiency level didn't get included in the proposal to change the ratios. But again, that certainly can be something that we really draw out as part of that narrative piece as we think about continuing to move these proposals forward. Dr. Thank you.

[00:42:12] Dr. But unfortunately, I don't have more context. Dr. Ms. Holtan. Dr. So just to respond to your general comments, and then I think it might be helpful for us to go through at some point go through these one by one but I I am in agreement that we need to think about a different approach on messaging I I do think that money is not irrelevant and and so part of part of our point is that if it is our duty our obligation to set standards of quality that ensure all

[00:42:50] students have an opportunity have access to high quality instruction and and the necessary ancillary support and part of our overall evaluation is that the current SOQs as funded are not meeting that standard and that therefore with current resources that's it's not just a matter of shifting dollars from one category to another that there is a need to enhance the overall um resource package and to differentiate and and i do think this is a concept that's different uh

[00:43:29] in in this stroke of the version of the soqs than in in priors to differ differentiate more based on student needs and you know the research we did coming up to this version told us that students in in economically disadvantaged communities and families need more to get to the to get to successful outcomes and and so that concept of differentiating based on on student need I would think is a both that the bar needs to be raised overall and that

[00:44:08] on resources and that there needs to be a differentiation of resources that those are kind of messaging points that we should somehow figure out how to get in there. Okay, anybody else? Thank you, ma'am. If I may, you know, so at some point, may I suggest that we do walk through some individual ones, and I'd be happy to start with a comment or two on ones that are my, the ones that I have questions for Leslie on and/or that might be worth discussing. How could we possibly turn that down?

[00:44:42] Well, so I'll toss out, I've got a couple, I mean, I think we ought to think about whether to back some off. And then I've also got a couple that I want to think about whether we want to add and or expand. And the back off is I do wonder whether, you know, the specialized student support, we had recommended four per thousand based on our research and the importance of those positions. And the General Assembly has now funded three per thousand. Can we really say that, know we had evidence base that four was magic over three i'm not sure we can and so is that really

[00:45:23] something that is useful to remain in there i'm not sure the counselors we did have a basis for our recommendation of one to 250 and that one may be one we want to keep in there on the other hand i mean it may you know if the general assemblies is gone as far as they're going to go on that one you know I think it's worth thinking about whether there's we're thinking about whether we want to declare victory and I don't know whether there's I mean as I say that is different because we did have an evidentiary base for the 250

[00:46:02] things that I would like to think about expanding is one is the I want to I have some questions about the equity fund and and if you could go back to that oh it's They're good. I'll ask that and then the other one is the work base learning coordinator and you know In both of those my question is have we gone bold enough and then the third category of a new category is I would like to understand better the the Department of Education upgrades the the potential to use standards of quality to upgrade

[00:46:38] Staffing at DOE on school improvement and I'm not I don't have my head around I mean this standards of quality for the divisions. I don't understand how we can use that to Get more resources here. I'm not sure we can but that one might I think the JLARC recommendations were strong enough I'd hate to see us wait Unnecessarily on that if this is an opportunity, but I'm not sure it is so so if I can go to my equity fund And then I'll stop in just a second the equity fund I don't remember how much we were just our original recommendation was moving the equity fund

[00:47:17] From outside SOQs into inside SOQs and how much we were enhancing it And if we enhanced it, I don't remember how much we were I don't remember by what percentage we Enhanced it, but the research, you know, we've seen and maybe it's only gotten stronger the research I've seen anyway That that our students from disadvantaged families need, you know, maybe as much as a third to a half more Overall resources and that's you know, not that's teachers experienced teachers. That's all the ancillary supports

[00:47:56] It's the whole package deal, but it's a it's a big Delta and not a small Delta And I don't know whether if if our current recommendations were adopted What what kind of delta what kind of percentage increase? differentiation are we giving to our students in low-income Families over the overall average if it and maybe that's a not a great way to ask it But if you understand what I'm asking can you help me there sure and I can certainly start to speak to that And I don't know if it definitely and there was anything that you wanted to begin the conversation with I do also

[00:48:31] I also have my Office of Budget director here as well who might be able to help fill in some gaps on the monetary and budget piece. Dr. Leonard, it looks like you might have had something to start with, but I'm happy to jump in. Dr. I feel free to go first. Dr. Okay.

[00:48:47] Dr. But what I will say on this one is there are certainly options available to the board to ramp up that funding in the way that we set that ratio. So I would have to defer to the board on what you want that to look like.

[00:49:04] But I will say in response to Mr. Gecker's great comments around the intent of this fund and the notion of redistribution of teachers potentially, whereas that redistribution of teachers and incentives is an option, I don't know that even our language is that strong because I think the divisions are going to do more of what you were saying, Ms. Holton, where they were going to use this fund to start to build out a lot of wraparound services and it may not have turned into teachers.

[00:49:35] And so it might be worth the board looking at that language a little bit more wholesale And we did have some language about they could spend it to enhance teacher It's not quite as Gotcha. Yeah, so we might be able to strengthen that language. Well, I Mean I just want to have it be somehow connected to the evidence base and that you know that there there is evidence around Not just in small incremental spending but significant incremental spending for those neediest kids. And I don't remember whether it's a third or a half, but it's up in that

[00:50:11] range. And what would it look like if we put in an equity fund recommendation that actually matched that evidence? Sure. And to help fill in the gap of where we are with the current recommendation and some of the traction that we have seen, so the equity fund had a few different components to it since this is a per pupil add-on. This was combining two different sources of funding that's going to divisions currently one of them being the current risk add-on program which is based exclusively off off of calculations of free and reduced lunch students um so there were no additional contingencies or or calculation factors going into to that pot of money um and then there

[00:50:49] was also the prevention intervention and remediation fund which also took into account assessments um and so in doing so that that particular pot of money kind of saw um a little bit not as as wide of a variation between how that money was being directed to you know more wealthier school divisions versus those who are serving higher poverty students so we didn't see that quite the same scaling and differentiation on that bell curve when you added in that assessment component so this would be combining those two sets of funds into a single formula that more mirrors that current at-risk add-on which is again based on exclusively free and reduced lunch

[00:51:26] So in that way, the funding was finding its way to more targeted or more targeted to those school divisions that were serving the higher poverty students and not accounting for any other variables that may adjust those numbers. And the difference between what the formerly the at-risk add-on program was, so we saw again a significant jump in 2020.

[00:51:47] So I have the numbers in front of me somewhere. In 2018, the percentages, it's on a scaled basis depending on your percentage of free and reduced lunch. In 2018, that number was 13% in the first year, 14% in the second year. We saw a bit of an increase in 2019, so it went up to 14.5% to 16% in the second year.

[00:52:07] So this is the highest end of the scale, the most you could get as a per-people add-on. In 2020, we saw that jump go from 23 to 26 in the first and second year, respectively. There was a bit of a pullback because of the unallotments in COVID-19.

[00:52:22] And so the most recent budget, it's currently 19.9% in the first year and 26% in the second year. So over the course of several budget cycles, we have seen that number jump pretty significantly in the additional money that you can get for the per pupil add-on with the at-risk add-on.

[00:52:40] And again, that being more of the formula that we want to follow with the equity fund, since again, it's targeted exclusively based on the percentage of your students that are in poverty versus adding in those other factors and i will turn back to look to see if there's anything that that um ed wants to add to that discussion there while he's walking up so just if i understand at year two of the biennium if the current budget stays in effect students who are eligible for the at-risk add-on the division would get a 26 percent bump well that's not the right way to say it the

[00:53:17] The SOQ amount for those students would be a 26% bump over the allotment for other students. Yes, up to 26% depending on the percentage of students with ran and reduced lunch.

[00:53:33] So it is a scaled number depending on that percentage amount. Oh, sure. Good afternoon. President Gecker, Dr. Lane, members of the board. My name is Ed Lanz. I'm the director of budget here at the department.

[00:53:50] see if i can fill in a couple of gaps uh yeah the the add-on the current add-on program uh does provide up to a 26 increase over the basic aid per pupil amount just the basic aid per pupil amount there are several other per pupil drivers within soq but basic aid per pupil amount serve as the basis for that add-on um currently in the uh the board proposal i heard a question earlier related to what's what's happening in the equity fund proposal versus the the at the

[00:54:25] current at-risk and PIR programs what what's generally going on here is the methodology of recommended by the board back in 2019 has actually changed really the focus of the calc the calculation whereas previously it's on a per pupil amount the board switched it to a positional add-on so what the

current formula was really doing is calculating add-on positions and then converting those to a dollar amount based upon south funded salaries benefits and in the

[00:55:01] case of FY 22 a 5% compensation supplement so what's going on here is that when we perform the calculation as recommended by the board the the amount that pardon me the amount that is calculated is approximately 430 million dollars however the other portion of the board recommendation is to remove the existing at-risk and prevention intervention remediation programs which pulls back about 350 million dollars so you wind up with a statewide net effect

[00:55:38] of around seven gets seventy seven point nine million dollars and that's Those variances are really going to be very different based on your particular school division. And again, another thing to keep in mind is that the existing range for the at-risk add-on is a minimum of 1% and a maximum of 26%, whereas the board recommendation for the equity fund is a minimum 10% add-on and a maximum 65% add-on.

[00:56:10] so it's a it's a really pretty sizable methodology change although it looks similar so well again miss holding that that that that research that you were suggesting that might cost a third to half more the board took that into account in 2019 that's why the range was ramped up so high so if i may so that 10 to 65 so if our recommendation were adopted then this the funding

[00:56:48] and and and adequately funded then we would be funding as much as 65 above basic aid for divisions with very high percentages of very needy students and whereas where the general assembly has gotten themselves to has is move a big movement from not that many years ago it was at 13 percent and but now it's at 26 but we would be taking it up to yet again a doubling of that at the upper yeah And again, it's important to

[00:57:22] To to point out that the shift of focus of the board from the 2019 that's correct. Whereas the current At-risk program is a per pupil amount add-on. This is a positional add-on that this is that's how it's calculated in the board proposal Calculated that way, but we require essentially that schools with varying percentages of lower socioeconomics end up with those positions It's not divisional. That's correct And again, the add-on that's being tacked on to positions is based upon your free lunch rate, which is what's scaling between the 10% and the 65%.

[00:58:01] So I believe the minimum, Falls Church, at the minimum, would be getting the 10% add-on. And I believe it's Petersburg that's showing the 65% increase.

[00:58:19] Yes. But again, just to be clear, we require, would require either the additional positions to be at the higher poverty schools, you know, or using that same money to hire more experienced teachers. Right. I believe those are the prescriptions.

[00:58:35] Yeah, the uses of it are pretty flexible, but there was a contingency about grouping experienced or inexperienced teachers in any certain school, so that your quality of instructors are going to the folks that need it the most. Well, when you say they're flexible, I thought what we had built in were various, you know, maximum class sizes, essentially, unless they use the money specifically to hire more experienced teachers for those schools. And what I mean by flexibility is in terms of it can go towards staffing and teacher recruitment and retention. It can go to prevention, remediation, intervention programs. So the equity fund, the uses of it were fairly flexible. The equity fund, but not the

[00:59:14] board's prescription. The equity fund money is much more flexible as I understood it than what the board had prescribed. If the SOQs the board prescribed were adopted, I thought we had to dedicate that money into poorer schools. Well, and I thought, yes, it was by school rather than by division, but I don't think it was telling them they had to spend... So, for instance, a lot of those funds are currently use to purchase services from external providers, maybe vendors, et cetera, they could still do that.

[00:59:49] Yes. And that's my understanding of what I had read of kind of how we came to be at the equity fund prescription and how we have it worded in the current red line document for the SOQ prescriptions. Yeah. I think the intent of the board in 2019 was to allow the things that were qualified under at-risk and PIR to continue but to expand to these other allowable use actually require you to set maximum class sizes my understanding of the equity fund didn't have any specifics on class sizes

[01:00:23] there were there were contingencies for making sure again inexperience inexperience and inexperience or inexperience and experienced teachers respectively weren't grouped in certain schools so again we were making sure that that the division or schools rather and students that that would most benefit from high-quality instructors in their classroom, we're seeing an even distribution.

[01:00:44] But there were, again, my understanding of rereading the language was that there were no class size maximums that the SOQ staffing ratio would still apply, it was about a teacher experience. - Well, while you're looking at that, can I ask just another, the 60, I'm just a little, so if the total at-risk fund is at the 430 million level now, And that's general assembly Well, maybe I'm wrong about that. But anyway, I'm just trying to get the order of magnitude on the dollars right if we're talking about taking the maximum

[01:01:22] Category from 26 percent up to 65 percent an extra 80 million dollars a year A 78 million dollars a year will do that? Don't forget that it also removes the existing PIR program Which is about a hundred and twenty million dollars a year. So we're taking money from those other categories and rolling it into this And that gets us a fair amount of money, but but that's All right, so so is there some risk that some folks some divisions some schools will actually lose under this formula change?

[01:01:58] I guess yes, you give me about a minute. I can scan and let you know, but I don't believe that's the case I believe the Just look at false. I believe the formula recommended by the board When we were when they were in 2019 trying to figure out what percentages we were using we use some different amounts We got to 65 we got to a point where no school divisions were below their existing chapter 552 I'm just surprised that the amount of money it takes to get from 26% to 65% for the neediest Kids that that the that the overall Delta isn't bigger than it is and that and again

[01:02:38] And that's simply because there's another, when we talk about that 26 percent add-on, that's exclusively within the at-risk add-on. Part of the board proposal is not only to replace the at-risk add-on, it's also the prevention, intervention, remediation. So partly what you're saying is between the current at-risk add-on and the prevention, we actually are already doing effectively more than that 26 percent.

[01:03:00] Right. We're much closer to 65 percent than -- Yeah, the existing two programs in Chapter 552 combined are $350 million programs. So for our Standard 2, where we clearly, I think, set forth maximum numbers of kids per class, where are you funding that from?

[01:03:22] So I'll take that one. That is not coming from the equity fund. That's actually on the next page where we were essentially placing into the SOQ the K-3 class size reduction money, and that's already paid for so yes it's true that we're mandating certain class sizes but that is paid for in a separate fund we did not

braid those two together into the equity fund but the policy matters because it does require then that they actually mandate that it mandates those ratios and they cannot turn the money down we actually do have some school divisions that from time to time will turn down that money and a distinction there too you know moving it into the soq is it

[01:04:01] is codified language, and with the budget being up for review every year, the potential for that incentive program to be taken off the table, it's a little bit more vulnerable in the budget. Of course, it doesn't have to be codified, right?

[01:04:16] In the first ten years of the Virginia Constitution, the modern Virginia Constitution, they didn't codify the SOQs. Sure. I think just as we think about the SOQ and the current codified form, by shifting it over to the SOQ, flagging the importance of using the incentive money, recognizing some of the value of having lower class sizes at those lower level grades, and further cementing that as a requirement for divisions.

[01:04:44] Ms. Hulton, anything else on that topic? I think you've convinced me that our equity fund is more robust, our standard that we we have set, I'm trying to get my language right, Mr. President, is adequate based relative to that evidence base, or at least it's within the range relative to that evidence base.

[01:05:16] So I'm not recommending any change on that unless others help me understand it differently. The one other one I was going to speak to was the work-based learning coordinators. This was one where I had originally advocated for more and will now take the chance to raise that again, that really the work-based learning, the whole idea of a work-based, and we're going to hear from Barry Duval from the Chamber of Commerce tomorrow and maybe that will help inform our thinking on it, but to really make the work-based learning mandates for high

[01:05:52] schools work, we've got to have somebody essentially in every high school and maybe some smaller high schools, it might be a half-time person, and some larger high schools, maybe it should be two, but I'd love to see a one per thousand ratio work-based learning coordinator mandated.

[01:06:14] And what we did last time is we, I think I raised this one fairly late in the conversation, and we were already pretty far along the way in other recommendations, but this is one that, and and so we just put in some regional coordinators, but this would be to work I I think schools that are taking seriously high schools that are taking scarcely where what we've Told them to do around career and and and community business connection Are hiring people so just a comment mr. Gecker if I may

[01:06:53] Just will always Do be able to do more with more so Certainly, I'm supportive of anything you think there. I just wanted to do a couple reminders on this one. One is that you're essentially funding in your Perkins plan that you approved last year what you've recommended here.

[01:07:16] And so the reason we haven't really pulled this one off yet is because that Perkins fund is like the K-3 class. I subject to revision from time to time. And so, you know, making some permanency out of this one is important to us.

[01:07:32] In terms of what would be needed at the high school level, and I would limit it to high school, not a general one to 1,000, but if you were going to use a ratio like that, I would use high school ratios. But I would say that if we were going to go that route, I would want to have the board do a little bit more research on that.

[01:07:54] But I would also suggest that it be broader than a work-based learning coordinator. We've seen some benefits with career coaches maybe combined with work-based learning if we got to the school level. And then keep in mind that we did go with the regional model, and this SOQ did intend to fund positions at the DOE, and that's partly, I think, where JLARC followed on thinking the OSQ might be considered in that same type of movement.

[01:08:22] So we have some precedent for that, and I can get into, I know that was another one of your questions, I can get to that one later, but I would see that what you're recommending being more robust as being something we should look at but i would not change what this is in that context i would think differently about what you really want in that high school because i think we're still going to need the idea of the regional coordinators with was that uh you're looking at job data in i'll use localities that i work in guggland louisa powhatan all together it's it's the same data yet you see vastly different cte programs in a lot of those localities and how

[01:08:59] How could we coordinate a regional solution to bringing business strategy into job training at the high school? I still think that's necessary. Part of your point is that the regional coordinators is not a substitute. It's independent of, and maybe we need both and, the high school-based coordinators.

[01:09:17] I accept the friendly amendment of it, not just being work-based learning, but work-based/career coach. For what it's worth, I'll just say it's almost a way to think if we back off on our school counselor recommendation, the difference between the one per 325 and one per 250, this is almost a different way of describing an extra counselor for each high school.

[01:09:47] I had not jumped in on a response to thinking about that. As it relates to a couple of these where we did some partial funding, I would not assume that the General Assembly was done, that they were satisfied with three, that they did three because it's maybe what they felt like they could do, and they really did want to get to four.

[01:10:13] And I think with counselors, it's the same thing. I think that you could potentially look at backing off on the counselor piece at elementary and middle, but the 250 to one in high school is a pretty important ratio when you think about the responsibilities and prepping students for college and everything going on there.

[01:10:30] - I'm sorry, then I'll, but maybe we keep to our one to 250 recommendation on counselor and describe that person as helping address the work-based learning career piece. - Sure, Dr. Durant.

[01:10:45] - I just wanted to come, I would not be supportive reducing the counselor, I think we had a lot of research that talks about the need for that one to 250 and at the elementary, really what we're seeing now even more so the social emotional learning needs and how counselors can really support that, whether it's in the classroom, connecting with resources in the community.

[01:11:03] So that 250, we didn't select arbitrarily. That came from some research showing the need for that. And I think defining it for elementary now, even more so than ever, what we're seeing coming out of the pandemic, it's a real need. Even 250 is a stretch in some cases.

[01:11:19] So I think I would just advocate to my colleagues that we keep that. And I do agree with what Dr. Lane was saying. And I heard, followed some of the conversation at the General Assembly, people wanted to do more and it was just a priority at the time right but i think that they understand and are even

seeing more and more the need the general assembly for why this is so important okay anybody else no yeah of course dr wilson just a minor um suggestion on slide um 10 where

[01:11:56] we talk about the recommendations from the aasac i think the way we want to word that is to require every division staff one cultural competence and inclusive practices coordinator because the way it reads right now is we have one person who's culturally competent in the division and that's not really what we want sure i can make that adjustment for future discussions there thank you for catching that and mr gecker i i just had one last comment this one i promise will be quick if i may sure uh dr mann had asked about how we might think differently about these in the context

[01:12:33] of COVID, and I just wanted to give some ideas there. I don't know that I would think about the SOQ with its longevity in the context of COVID, but we are really spending a lot of time with our divisions trying to identify priorities of how they spend this across the three CARES funds, $3 billion, and then, of course, early childhood is a lot more money on top of that. We have set priorities as a department, but rather than SOQ, one of the things I might would recommend to the board is we could work in partnership to identify priorities for LEAs spending of their money

[01:13:09] together and bring more attention to that so that we have this belief that with this huge one-time investment, the idea that I think came from Congress was that we were doing this to show that if we had this big investment of money, we could really make a difference in student outcomes and then it would give us an opportunity to advocate for more of that money permanently.

[01:13:34] And I think that some school divisions are thinking about that money in a variety of different ways that always aren't pushing towards student outcomes. And so that is an area where the board can go back to their comp plan and say, how might we help them think through some of these federal funds that will lead to outcomes?

[01:13:50] And then some of those things that are necessary but maybe don't lead to outcomes, we can advocate for in other ways, like infrastructure packages, state funding, set-asides, and the such. So I don't have an answer for you on that yet, but that's a way that the board could weigh in on that issue.

[01:14:09] No, thank you, Dr. Lane. I appreciate that because I think one of the things that was operating in the back of my mind when I raised the question is that for sure the SOQs are about the long game, and if there is momentum in certain areas because of the pandemic and there's the permanency path with SOQs, it's really trying to not lose the opportunity to drive in that direction because there are areas that are have some pretty acute needs and Dr. Duran's reference to social emotional learning and just the overall emotional climate of what classrooms feel like

[01:14:47] and teachers feel like operating in these spaces right now it's so the mentoring and those elements that might lead to retention those are all things that we don't want to miss the boat on really pressing for because we don't want to see a mass exodus. We already are facing a crisis in public education with respect to having access to quality educators. And let's make sure to, like, use that leverage point, too, as we're thinking about if we have to prioritize and where's the leverage using that lens.

[01:15:21] Okay. Dr. Robertson. Slide 11. I know it's about preparing for future review cycles, and I think that's highlighted there particularly as it relates to i guess it's slide 12 uh slide 12 uh highlighting the review of uh school facilities i um i do hope that um much of the content that dr lane shared at the commission on school modernization is going to be um highlighted in this presentation because it

[01:15:57] was very effective and it's well developed and uh i believe will um will help paint a great picture for the board as we consider that, thank you. - Ms. Halton. - So, just to circle back on the, so I'm comfortable with the recommendation that we maintain the one to 250 on counselors.

[01:16:21] I'm just frankly thinking of how we communicate the need most effectively, and I wonder if we could, on the school counselor recommendation, think about including some language. School counselors to include work-based learning, slash career coaches at the high school level.

[01:16:39] You know, this is essentially a language thing, but that might help clarify the need. So that's one thing I'll toss out there. And the other is just revisiting back to the specialized student support personnel.

[01:16:56] I'm tossing out the suggestion that perhaps we consider withdrawing the recommendation of four per 1,000 in light of the general assemblies, accepting three per 1,000, enacting three per 1,000.

[01:17:15] - Again, the three to four, I don't know that they were done, but understand if that's where the board wants to go on. The counselors, before you add any job responsibility, I would really encourage us to bring in VSCA or someone just to talk to you about that before you accept that.

[01:17:34] - Okay, and we will have another shot at this anyway. It is my hope that the board, the full board, this committee will once again prescribe standards of quality subject to the revision only by the General Assembly as required by the Constitution, you know, toward the end of 2021, as we did in 19 and we did in 20. We can certainly hash through these things. It is also my hope that with staffs help, we can frame what we're doing, and I certainly understand the importance of the money,

[01:18:05] All right. But when we are trying to, I think, affect a policy change, it is important, as Dr. Wilson said, to answer the why question, you know, almost first and then talk about how much it's going to cost to get there.

[01:18:22] Because, you know, honestly, in the context of what we spend for education, the budget, you know, and overall in the state, it is not a huge increase. You know, what we would want to do is not a, you know, does not hugely increase the state's budget for education. On the other hand, how some of that money would be spent, as I said before, with regard to, you know, reducing class sizes in certain schools with a higher incidence of lower socioeconomic students, we believe, as research indicates, that would make a difference.

[01:18:55] you know the counselors make you know impact on student achievement is a little bit lesser perhaps the principles is higher i mean we can talk through the research and the effect size of each of these proposed changes if it comes down to we want to actually you know prioritize you know i was certainly heard to say during the assembly session that you know standards of quality are like my children uh we're not supposed to have favorites although you know here we may actually have to break down and say, yeah, some of these things will have more impact on student outcomes, and frankly, although I haven't mentioned it, I certainly don't

[01:19:32] mean to exclude it, you know, the reading specialists, you know, clearly the importance of being able to read, every child being able to read by third grade is, you know, that research is well known, well documented, so I don't mean to exclude that by not having mentioned it specifically.

[01:19:48] The overall point being that when we list things this way, to me, we lose sight of the systemic changes we're looking to make. And I think there might be a way to deal with the policy change and the

cost in the same document, but perhaps not in the bullet list fashion we've been doing it. Okay. I think that's it for the SOQ committee.

[01:20:14] Thank you for your attention and comments. And I guess we are adjourned. Next up will be Dr. Anderson's committee at 2:30. Either, I guess, Dr. Anderson or Dr. Wilson. So thank y'all.

[01:20:32] Thank you.

[01:35:03] Everyone, thank you all for joining us today for the meeting of the special committee to review the standards of accreditation. I am not Dr. Anderson. She, though, is on the line participating off-site, so Dr. Anderson, welcome. I'm looking up in the air as if you are there.

[01:35:23] Thank you for joining us. We are delighted to certainly be back in this room live and to be able to feed off of one another's energy as we continue this important work. And also welcome to those who are joining us via YouTube. I'm pleased to report that on Dr. Anderson's behalf, we are in the homestretch of this work and thank the committee very much for all of the dedication and focus you've provided over the last many months that have brought us to this point.

[01:35:53] Over the few months that we have ahead of us, we will be wrapping up our work and making recommendations to the full board for proposed changes to the standards of accreditation. Our conversation that we had this past June helped provide VDOE staff with direction on specific substantive edits based on our work and discussion over the past year.

[01:36:20] Before we move into the presentation that Dr. Sayle will lead us through in the committee's discussion, it's our hope that committee members have had the opportunity to review the minutes from our June meeting. And if so, I'll entertain any changes or revisions to those minutes.

[01:36:38] Not hearing any of those then, or if I don't hear any of those, then certainly a recommendation or to move, a motion rather, to approve the minutes from June 16, 2021. Thank you, Dr. Anderson for moving to accept the minutes as presented for June 16, 2021.

[01:37:03] Is there a second? Not everyone at once. That's okay. You can still. I will second. Thank you, Dr. Duran. All in favor? Aye. Any opposed?

[01:37:18] Thank you. Those minutes will stand approved. We do have time here in our agenda for public comment. So at this moment, if there's anyone here who would like to address the committee during public comment, we ask that you would raise your hand and we will certainly recognize you.

[01:37:41] Thank you, sir. Please come forward. The podium is here. You're welcome to come to the podium. And we would ask, sir, that you provide us your name and then spend two or three minutes with your public comment. My name is Christian. I'm a school board member in my first meeting, and I'm really delighted to see everybody here.

[01:38:19] My comment is related to the initial initiative of 5C, which was launched, I think, a few years ago for a graduate profile, for a senior graduate profile.

[01:38:36] So I'm just wondering how that particular concept the school board is going to situate in the school division. Is it going to have the same design or is it because of these new challenges which are coming in that 5C concept will be given less power?

[01:39:02] Thank you, sir. Sir, for our minutes, would you mind spelling your last name for us? Last name is Agrawal. Thank you, sir. We will have someone on staff who will respond to you, your question regarding the five C's and how its implementation will move forward. Thank you so much for being here and welcome to the School Board of Colonial Heights. Thank you. Anyone else?

[01:39:36] Seeing no one else who would like to speak during public comment, I'd like to move then into our specific items for this afternoon's agenda finalizing the proposed amendments to the standards of accreditation we're pleased to welcome again dr. Leslie sale video e director of policy dr. sale will be walking us through a series of pending this decision points with her presentation today and again I'll emphasize decision points those decision points include action items outside of regulatory language changes that support the standards of accreditation,

[01:40:16] technical edits that clarify existing provisions in the SOA, and substantive edits the VDOE staff and stakeholders have provided. After each section of the agenda, Dr. Sayle will take a moment to pause to allow us as committee members to raise questions and to have discussion.

[01:40:38] As a committee, it is certainly critical that we reach some level of consensus today to each of the decision points so that we allow the VDOE staff to bring forward final recommendations to us at our meeting in September for consideration and approval.

[01:40:57] Additionally, staff will take these decision points forward to stakeholders during the month of August to ensure public engagement on each of them. For committee members and the public, you do have a redline document with specific language changes that accompanies this presentation in the materials that are found online.

[01:41:18] At this point, I will turn the presentation or the podium, I should say, over to Dr. Sale to walk us through each of those decision points. Dr. Sale, welcome again. Thank you. Thank you. Thank you, Dr. Wilson. I feel like I hardly need to make a presentation. That was very thorough of an overview of what we're going to be tackling here today.

[01:41:37] So now nearing I guess almost a year or a little over a year of this committee's work, we've had the opportunity to hear from a number of stakeholders and panel discussions, from staff presentations, a number of different inputs and things for us to consider.

[01:41:53] And so this presentation in a lot of ways is a synthesis of that work and where the board discussion has taken us. And reflecting on those outstanding decision points as Dr. Wilson mentioned, that will be critical for us to finalize as we move into the next phase of this work and finalize this initial phase of regulatory action as well as action items that exist outside of the SOA.

[01:42:15] So there are a few different things we'll be tackling and addressing here today. As we were putting together this presentation, we found ourselves kind of organizing the decision points into three different buckets, and that's how we will talk about the different items here as part of this presentation.

[01:42:32] First are the action items that we feel support the standards of accreditation and our accountability model, but do not necessarily require any regulatory or language changes to the standards of accreditation, so still well within your purview as you looked at accreditation and accountability more broadly, but not reflected in the language document that you see before you.

[01:42:52] The second item are the technical edits, which makes up a large portion of the working document and redline document that you all have had a chance to review. And these are really clarifying edits. There are no substantive policy changes for those items that were considered technical edits.

[01:43:11] But this was just making sure that the board's vision and philosophy and intent was clearly captured throughout the standards of accreditation after its most recent revision in 2017 and reinforced clearly throughout the document. Additionally, the Virginia Department of Education had the opportunity to convene an internal work group on the SOA after the 2017 revisions and had received feedback from stakeholders in terms of questions and inquiries that helped guide us in thinking about what we could do to assist with implementation because as we know the SOA is also a working document for many of our schools and divisions so

[01:43:46] we wanted to make it as functional as possible. And then lastly we will take a look at some more substantive edits so these are the items that that the board has discussed and raised as a priority and places that they would like to see changes and we felt like the the SOA and regulatory language was the appropriate avenue for these last substantive edits some of these are based on stakeholder feedback and and panel discussions as well as board discussion and some of these are being raised from from BDOE staff based on our internal discussions that were born from the implementation committee so as Dr.

[01:44:19] Wilson noted this presentation is formatted a little bit differently than and how we normally do things, we will have those points of pause and check in with the committee members. So none of our decision points get lost in the broader conversation at the end. And we're able to hone in on and finalize these last pieces to close out again this phase of the work.

[01:44:44] And I won't restate what we have here. That was more or less what I had just provided. So I will quickly jump to the next slide to start us with our first set of decision points, which are around suggested actions support the standards of accreditation again these are not accompanied by regulatory language changes but do talk to the larger conversation around accountability and how we we approach that and support that through other action items the first item we have here is starting to think about access to academic rigor and how we better understand um how or how advanced coursework is being made

[01:45:22] available to students and who is taking that coursework so the master schedule collection is an existing data collection that's available through the virginia department of education and our current data collection schedule and this actually allows us an opportunity to understand which courses are being offered at the division and school level through a course descriptor item or a data collection point called sced course level we can understand the the level of rigor associated with the different courses that our schools and divisions are offering and from this data collection we think we're able to better understand and capture a picture

[01:45:59] of what access to academic rigor looks like and we know that this is important for one of the board's goals and addressing the opportunity gap so we want to make sure that all of our students and all learners across Virginia have equal opportunities to challenge themselves and take coursework that aligns with both their interests and their skill levels and challenges them to grow so from this additional collection or I guess from data that is being collected through the the master schedule collection we can kind of get a full picture of what access looks like and it's not just a function of availability but it's also how we see enrollment happening in these divisions

[01:46:37] so who are utilizing these courses or I guess rather for this point if these courses are being utilized and then who is utilizing those courses so we get to see what we consider three dimensions of access as we think about academic rigor and advanced coursework again to hit the highlights that looks like availability enrollments and the demographic of who is taking those courses so we have let school division know that this is going to be an important data point for this year that the board has expressed interest and understanding what academic rigor looks like and what access looks like in those spaces and it to that end we've really requested school divisions who are

[01:47:16] providing us this data to take a closer look to make sure that that's accurate information and that data is verified. So as we build from that data, we're confident that we're operating from accurate and true data. From there, we should have the ability to make that information publicly available on the school quality profiles as early as fall 2022. And as you'll see, and part of the next slide, we'll talk about this a little bit more broadly, but a big piece of this is we understand transparency and data and reporting to be an important part and important leg of our accountability model so by making this data more

[01:47:54] visible more transparent putting this out to school divisions we can see the gaps and where students have the opportunity to challenge themselves with academic and advanced coursework and school divisions have the tools and resources and data to improve practices in terms of access the next item has been a topic of a lot of discussion for this group and that is discipline disproportionality data similar to our access to academic rigor this is something that we're actually able to leverage I guess I should say an evolving data collection to better understand what we're seeing in terms of

[01:48:32] discipline practices and how that's impacting certain student populations and certain student groups so we are currently in the process of transitioning away from the discipline crime and violence reporting to what's called SBAR or the student behavior and administrative response collection which gives us a fuller picture and a more complete picture of how um school discipline is being administered and and the responses and the student demographics um that have been subject to disciplinary action i will note here that the the date and school year that we have the s s bar collection coming online was this past school year but because of covid this has been delayed

[01:49:08] so s bar will actually be its first year of data collection with this new model will be in the 2021 2022 school year so just wanted to quickly note note that change but but with that in mind this data will also be available for us to look at and reflect on by fall of 2022 as part of the school quality profiles as well in the interim we have an opportunity as staff to really hone in on what the methodology for this calculation will look like and as we've heard from previous presentations discipline disproportionality will be a ratio based calculation we know that there are some different ways of approaching that ratio including

[01:49:48] you know risk quotients understanding whether we're reflecting on full student populations versus subsets and so we wanted to make sure that we're thoughtful in how we're reporting this data in fall of 2022 and so we will use this additional time as sbar data is coming in to reflect on that methodology and really cement that so that will be an ongoing part of the board's discussion or committee's discussion to finalize that methodology but we are confident in the ability to be able to report and make that data publicly available by fall 2022 again we feel that that this data and reporting piece is an important part of our accountability mechanism

[01:50:24] and understood as part of our larger approach to accountability so we think that this is an important complement and meaningful complement to the standards of accreditation and then of course as this data becomes online and becomes available, the board or, you know, second iteration of the committee has the opportunity to evaluate and see if there is indeed a need to change the standards of accreditation regulatory language or accreditation model. But in this interim phase, we felt this was a meaningful and important step in getting us to that conversation that lends itself to those evidence-based discussions and database discussions that we know are important

[01:51:01] um for the board and making those decisions so those are the two pieces that exist outside of the standards of accreditation um that we wanted to make sure that the board is comfortable with with that approach um and providing this this next step and next phase um and and addressing these components of an accountability model so i will pause there for any questions or discussion on these two pieces of the puzzle any questions or comments from uh anyone who's here not just committee members but also board members who are attending any questions or comments for dr sale

[01:51:36] dr man thank you dr wilson oh boy just so excited to see this first recommendation i think it's a passive but powerful way of inviting examination of what we're doing around access to rigor i i mean i'm sitting here i'm trying to find on the website where i can get to the school quality profiles because I feel like there's just no better way to regulate than to have access to information that tells us if we have a problem or not.

[01:52:09] And so I thank the committee for calling this forward as a very helpful interim recommendation to advance. Very much support it. Thank you. Other comments? Ms. Holton.

[01:52:24] Thank you. Yes, I endorse Dr. Mann's comments. that academic rigor in particular, here's my question. I see that you're going to be, we can create metrics for availability of advanced coursework, enrollment, diversity of populations taking advantage, all of that's kind of towards upper grades, and so the referrals for gifted programming in the lower grades, is there a way to do some data collection on that and to measure opportunities for extra academic rigor at the elementary level in

[01:53:00] protect us sure doctor then you are shaking your head um i can certainly bring that back to our data team to see you see what might be possible i certainly don't want to speak out of turn for for other staff members who really lead the charge on data collection work um but i will certainly bring that back to see if there's a way that we can understand what advanced coursework or or exposure to advanced you know instruction looks like at earlier grades and how we might be able to collect more information i'm just channeling mr gecker who's talked uh for us to a while about you know the isn't issue isn't who gets into governor schools for instance it goes all the way back to who is being prepared at a very early age for those

[01:53:40] opportunities and I think there might be some opportunities to do exist or leverage existing work that's happening in the department as we know the the regulations for gifted education are under review at the moment and and we're looking at gifted education very closely for these access components and so you I will make sure that those conversations are interfacing with one another so we have a kind of a full scope and understanding of how we can look at access beyond the higher grade levels if that's available to us. I feel really confident that will be the way that this is written will expand the middle school the element elementary schools are not always differentiated that way

[01:54:19] but we we would be able to identify you know kids that are in special programs but a lot of times the gifted programs in elementary schools are actually inclusive and not always a separate pullout

type of program they're they're clustered together but they're clustered together in a class with more general education students let's say so my experience when when some of my children were had opportunities to take advantage of incredibly wonderful gifted and talented programs in the elementary level they were essentially pullout programs but it's not

[01:54:55] anything anybody would call advanced coursework right so it wouldn't be captured by these by these terms but it was extra programming that they were pulled out for and you know maybe the challenge is to distinguish pulling out for gifted and talented versus pulling out for meetings particular needs of particular students but I think we should try to address it through and it can get complex. I mean, I'll use my home school division as an example. There are kids that are

[01:55:31] pulled out of their school and placed into a center-based gifted program. And then there are kids that are clustered together at their home school, what they'll call a site-based gifted. And then there are kids that, and this isn't my home school, but it's quite common that when I was in a smaller school division, there were maybe four gifted kids in the grade level.

[01:55:52] So they were all just in a class with other non-gifted children, but they received some type of extra support. So I feel really confident in what we can provide you in the way that this is written. It may take us, you know, moving through the gifted regulations and some of the things that you're trying to do there before I would feel comfortable reporting anything on a school quality profile on some of those other factors.

[01:56:17] But we hear the point. We'll take it back and see what's possible. Dr. Drong? Thank you. My comments are on the second one, and I'm really, really pleased with the discipline and disproportionality on data that will be collected. And I know the work group will be finalizing the methodology, but I really hope that the methodology will really be focused on not just the reduction that we've seen.

[01:56:40] We've seen a lot of data reports that have shown many, many discipline infractions have been reduced over time. We've seen those national reports. But when you look deeper, the disproportionality in some cases actually increased. So while there may be less suspensions, for example, overall in a school, it's been found many, many times that disproportionality for our young men of color tend to actually have increased when that's happened.

[01:57:07] And so this to me is so critical if we're really going to get at the heart of what we're trying to do here, which is the first one, which is access to rigor. If you're not in the classroom, you have access to nothing. So if you're constantly being disciplined disproportionately, then the first part is irrelevant sometimes for those students.

[01:57:22] and what we're trying to provide here. So I really strongly hope that the methodology will really be able to highlight on the school quality profiles those instances where, yes, we see reductions of discipline infractions. That's great. But what does that really mean for the students in those schools?

[01:57:37] Because it's really troubling to me having seen data that shows for certain students when the discipline infractions have decreased, their interactions with discipline has actually increased. And that is an area of great, great concern. So thank you for that.

[01:57:53] And then just a question is, who will be on the work group, and then what is the timeline for the methodology, and will we be able to review it, or what's that look like logistically? So right now we have

it generally for this coming fall. So wanted to make sure that the decision points that we have here extend us in the direction of this being an adequate approach for this interim phase.

[01:58:13] So pretty much immediately upon approval of this approach, we can bring staff together to take a look at that. And I'm sure it will expand past staff as well to make sure we have stakeholder representation and external feedback on what that methodology looks like.

[01:58:29] And then I feel quite confident in saying that we can certainly bring this back for you all to look at and reflect on via presentation or written report or what might be helpful or useful. Thank you. And we can't say who's on the workgroup now, but typically we will always have a superintendent representative, a principal representative, teacher representative, counselor representative.

[01:58:50] In this specific one, we'll probably have some folks in the data collection world and then some folks that work in the mostly larger school divisions that have this, but discipline offices. And so certainly if there's a specific constituency you want to make sure is represented, let us know.

[01:59:07] Well, hopefully, after many school divisions have equity, chief of equity or equity folks, it would be great to have someone from one of the divisions who really looked into this issue around discipline and have their equity lens on it. Because I think that's the disproportionality context.

[01:59:22] It's quite different than previously gathering discipline data. Sounds good. Thank you. Dr. Anderson, is there anything that you would like to add to this discussion? No. I just offer my appreciation as well to Dr. Sale for providing the overview of the information so thoroughly.

[01:59:43] No additional thought or questions for me to offer at this time. Thank you. - So Dr. Sayle, I think from a directional perspective, you have the sense that these two items are areas where the committee is quite supportive.

[01:59:59] I will note again that both of these items, the idea is to make the data publicly available in fall of 2022 via the school quality profile, correct? - Yes, yes ma'am. - The other thing that I would add whenever possible and appropriate, it may be interesting to have a student perspective on some of these.

[02:00:25] - And taking notes as we speak to make sure this is all carried back for the next phase of this work. - Okay. - All right. Our second bucket are suggested technical amendments.

[02:00:41] As I noted at the outset of the presentation, these aren't meant to be policy oriented or policy change recommendations, but really making sure that all of the discussion and intent and vision that came into and came behind the 2017 SOA revisions are clearly and consistently reflected throughout the document.

[02:01:00] And again, as school divisions use this as a operational and functional document that our intent and requirements and expectations are clearly laid out. To that end, as you're looking through the red line document, you'll find that most of the edits that we've included or suggested here are in part three, which includes our student achievement and requirements for graduation, as well as part four, our school instructional programs.

[02:01:27] Again, we find these to be probably most commonly used as a functional document to make sure that, or so that schools and divisions are ensuring that they're staying in compliance with instructional responsibilities and expectations, and then, of course, as students near the finish line for graduation, that they are checking and completing all of the boxes there.

[02:01:46] The red line document that you have in front of you, I will just note as you're scanning through and for the purpose of our discussion when we have the questions and recommendations phase of the conversation. You have seen several of these, and I would say actually most of these technical edits and earlier presentations, those in the index are indicated in white.

[02:02:09] So those are ones that should look fairly familiar. The ones that we have added since the last time we had the opportunity to bring this to you are indicated in green in your red line document, but are still considered technical edits. And then for the items that are considered substantive and we'll address in the next portion of the conversation, those are highlighted in blue.

[02:02:27] so if there's anything that you want to discuss or raise regarding those specific suggestions we will certainly have the opportunity to do that but those are the bigger policy discussions and changes that staff has identified with respect to the technical amendments i will flag a few that have been added since the last time you have had an opportunity to take a look at this document one of them is just comporting with a general assembly mandate that came out of the 2020 session senate bill 238 and that is with regard to full-time kindergarten programs so that is transitioning those remaining half-time programs which are are few and far between i think um at

[02:03:03] the time there were only one or two um to full-time kindergarten and making sure that that expectation is also reflected in the standards of accreditation um we strike language related to family life education to to ensure alignment with new changing statutory requirements i will note that there is no change in family life education instructional programs or policy changes to coincide with that the reason for this change is we know that family life education is of interest to the general assembly and we do often see changes in what they suggest from an instructional standpoint so we wanted to make sure our regulatory language was as accommodating of those changes as possible

[02:03:41] so if there are future changes that doesn't necessarily require regulatory change so sets out the broader parameters for family life education but but doesn't require specifics so that is a little bit more agile there similarly the last technical edit that is new for this group is language on fire and lockdown drills this is another area in which the general assembly has made some adjustments over the last few years and so to keep our regulatory language in line we've also been been reactive to those general assembly changes so this generalizes the language a bit make sure we are up to date and in the line with the statutory language and for both

[02:04:19] of these requirements in addition to what we set out in general or code language and regulatory language there are some requirements that come from the statewide fire prevention code as well as the department of criminal justice service or student services with regard to lockdown drills and so making sure that that schools understand the expectations are both from the educational side as well as other regulatory requirements that are placed on them so again with that i will pause there and and um just as a reminder it's the the white and green edits um that are up for discussion with with this phase as we consider those technical edits and we can certainly

[02:04:57] address any items in blue during the next phase and dr wilson while y'all are reviewing the document i miss holton i've already heard back on the data collection for enriched programs for elementary and middle school students shelly obviously is our expert that knows all this stuff and uh we do collect that data already so we'll be able to report it on quad with demographics it it is a it is a check box

that they fill out on every student so assuming the student has reported a reported race we'll be able to disaggregate it okay thank you dr lane any

[02:05:33] questions uh discussions or recommendations on the items that are uh actually in green or white correct and i know there are quite a few changes so i will also add a few in the white category yes um quite a number of changes there um we are just as an update of where we are in the regulatory process um so when this this committee brings its recommendations to the full board um that will represent first review of the proposed phase of regulations um you'll have another opportunity to look at those during the final review phase um but again that's that's only

[02:06:12] kind of phase one of the the full regulatory language change um so this this will not be the last opportunity you have to take a look at this language and evaluate but wanted to make sure that we we get the process started with as close to what we anticipate seeing as possible okay i don't think i see anyone prepared to chime in here dr sale so feel free to move on to the next section i'm sorry dr anderson before i do that did you have anything to add no i'm good um i don't have

[02:06:45] anything to add thank you dr sale and the last section here are our substantive proposals for consideration um so similar to that first bucket these are ones that the board has identified as as priorities and and things and action items that merit um some sort of change and and staff had identified these as being appropriate for a regulatory amendment so these do coincide with regulatory changes and so you'll see those language items um in blue in your red line document the first one and probably the meatiest one of this discussion here is students with limited and or

[02:07:25] interrupted formal education and this this proposal and recommendation is actually the culmination of a lot of different work so we've heard from divisions both as part of the discussions that we've had with this committee as well as informally at the agency you know concerns around how the dropout rate and and GCI and accreditation is impacted by this particular subset of English learners we also had a legislative mandate in 2020 senate bill 933 that that required the department to take a look at or rather establish a common statewide definition of scythe so we could begin to collect data on the student demographic better

[02:08:01] understand where they are in the state and from that building from that data collection start to understand the types of services and supports being offered to these students and then of course we know just from from demographics and changes and what we see of our student population with a With a growing number of English learners across the state, we can expect that the number of SLIP students is also on the increase.

[02:08:26] And we know that these students face a specific set of challenges as they integrate into their coursework, knowing that they're behind and there's a bigger gap to catch up for. And then, of course, there's the compounding effect of late entry when these students are joining the public school system in their high school careers.

[02:08:44] So with that, we realized that there was probably a number of different ways to approach or tackle this issue and felt that this was most wholly addressed by a multi-prong approach to supporting SLIFE students and supporting divisions in their support of SLIFE students and making sure that that's accurately captured in our accreditation model as well.

[02:09:03] So I will walk through each of those individual prongs here. So currently in the SOA we do have a provision called the certificates of program completion and these are programs by which a student can be awarded and rewarded for completing work that doesn't necessarily match all of the requirements from a board prescribed diploma, but they're still able to reach a finish line and demonstrate and have something to show for all of the work that they put in during their high school career. So this language is set out in the standards of quality that the certificates

[02:09:40] of program completion should be made available to students who meet these prescribed programs, i guess courses of study um which make up these programs and those are established at the local level so it does really give the local school divisions a good degree of flexibility in what these programs can look like so they can really tailor it to the students needs to help support that in the standards of accreditation um we've realized that the the while that the certificates of program completion are pretty widely available that it's not as well understood or well utilized that this can be a pathway to completion for our students with limited and

[02:10:17] interrupted formal education and so there's an opportunity to amend the standards of accreditation language to align with the standards of quality and make sure it's very clear to divisions that this is an opportunity and a viable one at that first life students to reach a degree of completion and again have something to show for the work that they put in during their high school careers and while this change is being effectuated in the regulatory language to make sure it's clear to schools and divisions, we can also make an adjustment to the Standards of Accreditation Guidance document, which in part falls under the purview of the board,

[02:10:54] so that's language that we can bring back to, again, make sure the messaging is clear in this space. The Certificates of Program Completion for our SLEFE students who are given the opportunity to take advantage of these, and I'll pause there because I have a tickle in my throat.

[02:11:19] We're hoping that this adjustment will eventually have a positive impact in the accreditation rate by virtue of these students getting the certificates. And I apologize, this tickle is relentless.

[02:11:41] So for these students who get these certificates of completion, schools will see a positive impact on their accreditation rate through the GCI as well as dropout rate. So if we take a look at the calculations of how these are put together for accreditation, the graduation completion index is an aggregate score based on where students are in their cohort.

[02:12:03] So they get points for continuing their education. They get points for getting a diploma, they get points for continuing in their cohort, and they also get points for receiving a certificate of program completion. So by making this option more readily available, or I guess divisions aware of this option, that we're hoping to see a change in the graduation completion index by virtue of that up in score.

[02:12:24] That if these students are getting those certificates, it will be reflected in that aggregate. And then for the dropout rates, when they get a certificate of completion, these students are no longer considered a dropout. So they have reached a measure of finishing and completion there.

[02:12:39] So in that regard, we're hoping again that we already see an impact in the accreditation model by promoting the completion index, but there is more that we can do in this space. As I mentioned, this is a multi-pronged approach.

[02:12:55] So the second prong of this, I apologize, this is really hanging on here. While you're clearing your throat, I'll ask a slow question to give you a little bit of time. Um, you mentioned that, uh, with the certificates of program completion, those numbers, those students count toward graduation as well as don't count against a school for dropout.

[02:13:24] Does the student who achieves a certificate of program completion count the same as a student who receives a diploma? So no, there is a differentiated score, um, for the certificates of program completion. And I'm speaking off the cuff here, so I hope it's not incorrect.

[02:13:42] So it's 100 points is the maximum amount that each student could receive in the numerator when they're also counted in the denominator. For certificates of program completion, I believe that's 25 points. So it's so much better than zero as they would be counted for if they were considered a dropout for the GCI.

[02:14:01] And Shelly's nodding, so you... Another way of saying that is they receive a quarter point credit. essentially sure I think no tickle as of this moment so hopefully I will charge forward so the the second piece of this approach for our students with limited and interrupted formal education is actually looking at the accreditation model so we hope there are some some indirect impacts through the the certificate but we recognize that these students do have a disproportionate impact for those schools and divisions who are serving higher populations of

[02:14:38] those students and so to approach those we took a look at the appeals model which is already set out in the standards of accreditation and making sure that school divisions are aware that if they're that SLIFE students are the sole reason for a performance level designation in the dropout rate indicator there would be an additional space through the appeals process the board had heard a few of these cases in years past but the the data didn't indicate a need at the time to use the appeals process to make the adjustment to the designation so wanting to make sure that school divisions are aware schools and divisions are aware of this

[02:15:14] as a viable pathway to appeal their performance level indicator when against life students are the sole reason for a shift down and that performance level designation as part of this of course a baseline expectation is we want to make sure we're still incentivizing these schools and divisions to be serving these students so a baseline expectation would be that the schools must certify that they do have programs of completion for these students to access and providing support for them so again making sure that we're incentivizing that school divisions are serving those and not leveraging the appeal system as a relief

[02:15:50] gauge without matching that with a programmatic component but again making sure that they're aware that the appeals process is there for them and it's a viable pathway as we mentioned at the last slide because of this approach the data that we see happening through the accreditation model collection will still be true to the student demographic. We are not changing how we calculate GCI. We're not changing how we calculate dropout rates. And in this regard, students will still have a chance to reflect on how they're serving their entire student population and embark on that continuous improvement

[02:16:26] progress to make sure they're serving them all well. And that leads me to the third component of this which is the availability of data so to support them in this work we know that the data will be true to the fully capturing the student demographic but we can because we're collecting information on slave students at this point disaggregate the data to better understand how schools and divisions are serving this particular student population so again the numbers are true for the accreditation model they have the

appeals process to make any adjustments to the performance level designation and this is almost kind of a customer service component to make sure that we're giving them the tools and resources they need to

[02:17:06] identify gaps and and take programmatic steps to better serve these students so throughout this process we've talked about you know this the impact of these students on accreditation and so I know this is a bit of bearing the lead but an important delineation of kind of what student population we're talking about here this is primarily focused on our late entry SLIFE students so of course the hope is that if a SLIFE student joins us in elementary and middle school grades and stays with the Virginia public education system that we'll find ways to make sure we're catching them up and get them where they need to be. But we know that becomes exponentially more challenging when those students are joining us later in their high school careers and not always an opportunity to

[02:17:45] close that gap for those students. So when we think about who this appeals process would be eligible for and what student demographic we are really trying to understand and support here, It's focusing on a subset of our SLIFE students, specifically our late entry, and this is actually built from the definition that we had brought to the board that was a response to Senate Bill 933 that captures SLIFE as an entire student population, so this could be anywhere from kindergarten to 12th grade, but the late entry SLIFE focuses on those students who are recently enrolled in a Virginia public high school, no fewer than two years prior to the anticipated cohort graduation date.

[02:18:23] So that means that the schools have only really had a chance and opportunity to engage them and provide supports for less than two years prior to their expected completion date. Other than that, we still have those same components of this life definition that add to the identification component, that add the proficiency level, and then, of course, the degree of difference we see in their formal schooling from their peers, which is two years.

[02:18:47] Again, to help support school divisions and their programmatic improvement And and that continuous improvement model but also to aid them in the appeals process if this is an appropriate avenue for them This additional data and disaggregation of data will allow Again schools and divisions that are able to see what the outcomes of these students are and make adjustments and programming to support and serve These students so our next proposal that we put in the substantive category was our plans to improve equity outcomes

[02:19:23] And this is actually something that interfaces with that the first section on our action items that we're pursuing outside of the SOA. So we want true and accurate data to make sure we have a true picture of access to academic rigor and school disproportionality data. Oh, and I will -- it looks like Dr. Wilson might have a -- I'm sorry.

[02:19:43] Before we move into this -- because this is -- though it is still a substantive change, it's a new category. Yes. Maybe we should pause here and take comments and suggestions or questions around SLIFE, and then we can move forward. Does that -- Yes. Sound okay?

[02:19:58] And and to that in I I will add it's something I was gonna kind of tie us up with when we have the conversation about all of these But appropriate now is there has been some discussion about This approach not having I guess a clear enough Expectation for what the appeals process would look like for school divisions So we have considered some alternatives and options to expand and really I guess Submit is the best word I can think of the the appeals process So just of note for you all is as you begin your discussion that there are there are some other proposals or components of this proposal That we are

prepared to share with you all today if it's of interest in the board's will to move forward in a different direction

[02:20:37] Okay, great. Thank you. Dr. Don. Thank you. First, thank you for all the work on this area of SLIFE Colleagues are not surprised. This is a big area of mine that I've brought up for quite some time I do think it's important for two reasons one we want to what I believe this approach does continues to do is to bring attention to this group of students and making sure that all of our school divisions are doing everything they can to support them. So that is first and foremost and needs to be first and foremost in any actions we take. Having said that, what we've seen and we've had great public comment when we had our panels of superintendents and principals,

[02:21:14] and I've seen myself working in Northern Virginia school divisions, two different divisions, this particular group of students, the way that it's currently written, it is actually not supportive of school, the effort that they are doing to try and meet their needs. So currently, this, I think, will allow for school divisions to be recognized in that work while also making sure that those students are at the forefront of all of what we're doing.

[02:21:36] I was the one that raised the concern about the appeals process and had conversations beginning of this week. And there is language that I want to share with my colleagues, and it's in this document that was passed out to us. It's on page seven. And thank you, Dr. Sal, for writing this language up.

[02:21:54] It will be passed out. Oh, sorry. I thought it was passed out already. Pass it out. Thank you. But essentially, understanding the need to have this now in the appeal process as a way to move forward. I was hoping that we could find a way to not have to have it appeal, that it would be a part of the process.

[02:22:11] But I'm understanding why. I just want to be concerned then that because I don't think it should have to be a question up to us as the board whether or not we agree with it. I think it should be based upon the criteria. We need to verify that the criteria has been met.

[02:22:28] But I'm concerned that appeals would be at our discretion beyond that. And so what Dr. Sal has written on page 7 in the highlighted section is the board shall grant any appeal related to the performance level designation or the dropout rate indicator when the school board is able to demonstrate the late entry students in limited and or endless life students.

[02:22:52] And then it goes on to say that for any appeal related to the performance level designation for the dropout rate indicator that the chairman of the school board and the school superintendent must also certify the availability of certificate of program completion. And it also is very clear that it's only for guaranteed for four consecutive years.

[02:23:12] So in other words, for four consecutive years, the state board would have to accept the appeal if it met that criteria. And I think the four years is a good indicator because if this is happening year after year after year, then there should be other things looked at.

[02:23:28] But I'm very concerned if we do not have the shall grant in here that I don't believe that it really helps move forward with what we're trying to accomplish by putting it in appeals. I had hoped that it would not be an appeal, but again, I am very supportive of why it is there now.

[02:23:43] I'm not opposed to that as long as this is here. So I wanted to share with my colleagues the work that has been done on the conversations that I've had offline with Dr. Lane, with Emily and Dr. Sal, your work that you did, as well as Holly. Thank you for all the work you've done on this.

[02:24:00] And I hope that my colleagues can support me in my recommendation to make this slight amendment that would require no matter who is on the state board that this, because I don't want it to be at the discretion of who's deciding, you know, in our seats. This is something that could be many years to come, but what should be required is that they meet that criteria that I think has been clearly outlined, and then it would not be more than four consecutive years, and that they're also certifying that there is the availability of their certificate of program completion.

[02:24:33] So I think there's some guardrails there, but there's also a guarantee that I believe is necessary. For purposes of those who may be watching on YouTube or perhaps even listening, I think it's important to note here that the material, the item that Dr. Duran just referenced and read through is actually an addition to a section already which provides an appeal process for any other student.

[02:25:01] document, this is additive language to specifically provide that appeal process for SLIFE students. For those who are listening who may not be looking at the document, I think it's important to note that detail. Dr. Thank you, Dr. Wilson.

[02:25:18] So I would also welcome my colleagues if you have comments on that, but as we move forward and give guidance to staff who are going to bring this back forward, this is something that I think is very important for me, and I'm asking my colleagues for your consideration as we think about what we're really trying to put forward here in the substantive change.

[02:25:37] And this was in the section of substantive change. I do think it is substantive change, but if it's then left to the discretion of the board solely, I'm concerned at that point. - Dr. Mann. - Thank you, Dr. Wilson. I was sitting here just going back in my mind to the opportunities where we have had to hear appeals before the board on this matter.

[02:26:00] And I found myself wanting to make sure I'm correctly deciphering the distinction that these new recommendations afford because there is an appeals process that's already in place and we are adding language that makes an allowance for accreditation decisions that are impacted by schools that are serving SLIFE students to be a legitimate basis for appeal.

[02:26:37] And that's the distinction here. I mean, I just really wanna make sure I can like channel the past experiences we've had with school districts, petitioning the board for appeal consideration on accreditation outcomes, and how this is slightly different.

[02:26:56] I think it's nuanced, and I really wanna make sure I'm understanding the nuance. The main logistical thing that you're doing here, and then, of course, Dr. Duran's substitute that we passed around strengthens this, but at the heart of what you're doing is you're saying when you denied these requests in the past, individuals were applying under extenuating circumstances, and you were saying that this situation was not an extenuating circumstance because we didn't have enough information, we didn't have a definition.

[02:27:26] Now we have all of those things, and you're clearly denoting that when this situation occurs in a school, and that these students are the sole factor leading to the reduction of performance level, you consider that extenuating circumstance. Thank you, Dr. Lane, and in light of your comments, Dr. Duran,

you're saying that should not be subject to point of view, it should be granted for a four-year period, and after that time, there is then an opportunity to consider if there are other factors at play

[02:28:01] that might be driving um this particular outcome yes from a crime okay other questions or comments miss holton just that i think this is a good solution i hear you that you tried to figure it out how to fit it into the without having to go through the appeals process but i can see why you ended up in the appeals process and it's a good solution thank you dr anderson i had a good

[02:28:40] conversation earlier this week with uh i'm sorry can you guys hear me okay yes we can go ahead okay to make sure um i had a conversation earlier this week with dr lane and emily and uh they helped address some of the questions i had that were similar to some that were asked today um hearing dr duran's comments um one one thing that i i had asked is and i think comment was just made is after that four years is up uh a review of some sort would be conducted to see there's other

[02:29:18] other contributing factors contributing and i i asked the question more so what what occurs along the way or what uh what what expectations are kind of set along the way during that four-year period that would incentivize or put accountability on that school to be not only tracking that data but we're reacting to it does that make sense yes and providing the appropriate supports that would then at the end of the four-year period yield a different outcome is there any kind of review

[02:29:57] like a you know half way through review is this a status to say is there something occurring um that kind of keeps the a finger on the pulse of what's going on during that four-year period or is it even necessary i'm serious what the other committee and board members think i don't disagree I agree with the concept, just want to see if it's considering all the... Sure. Dr. Sayle?

[02:30:26] Sure. Well, as we noted before, a part of the multi-pronged approach here is making sure that our data is accurately capturing how these students are doing from an outcome perspective and a support perspective. So I think there's an opportunity here using the disaggregated data based on the new definition of our late-entry SLIFE. We still will have kind of to throw back to our earlier part of the conversation um those those public reporting and transparency components to the data so that will still be tracked on a year by year an annual basis as part of the accreditation model those numbers will be true and reflect those students um so you

[02:31:05] will be able to see the year over year progress in that regard um the appeals process even though we we do have it established as a shall grant um could still come before the board um so they they would still have an opportunity to present their case and demonstrate that for more or less an annual check-in on progress and things that they're changing as part of the appeals process, just as we would ask other appeals to appear before the board with the expectation that the feedback and information that they're putting forward is true, that you're able to indicate to them some opportunities for growth or change.

[02:31:37] And then of course, at the end of the four consecutive years, they would be held accountable to making those adjustments to ensure that they're serving those students. And I think those two items are kind of intuitively built into this current plan and model and language here, but if there are other opportunities to ensure that we're checking in at the right stages and right benchmarks, we can certainly talk about that.

[02:32:01] - Dr. Lane, and then Dr. Doran, I see you. - I just had one logistical thing while I'm sitting here, and Shelly and I had a quick sidebar on this. Whereas we have the definition of SLIFE, I think the definition of late entry SLIFE will need to be inserted into the definition section the SOA just so we can capture what that is, but that's, we can handle that offline, but I just want to make sure I told you that.

[02:32:21] Yep. And as a note for the definition section more broadly, we understand that some, many of the edits that we have here today might have an impact on the definition section. So we haven't made any changes to that yet, recognizing that that's the last phase of this to make sure we are defining accurately what is reflected in the rest of the document.

[02:32:40] So we can certainly make sure that that's reflected in the definition segment, and that will still be a part of the next phase. Dr. Drong? Yeah, thank you. Even though the word shall grant is there, and I think that's very important, I would not in any way say that wouldn't mean that we would ask questions and ask them to present data and through the appeals process, really want to understand what's going on.

[02:33:02] And up to the four years after that, then it's still the discretion they still could. But I don't want in any way to have it be heard by anyone in the public listening or my colleagues that I'm suggesting that we just say, oh, turn the piece of paper in and just do it automatically. I would still, as one board member, want to know a little bit more and ask a lot of good questions and have them to present what's really happening and really look at it.

[02:33:23] And that's why I really appreciated also the certification of their availability, of their certificate of program completion, and then some of the other things we want to see happening. My concern was just that it would not be at our discretion. Well, okay, well, that's not enough. Because I do believe that based on what we know for this population, the two years and the late entry is a isn't it defined by two years in this case i had discussion around that about the two years i'm fine with the two years but um i think that because of that and what we know about this population of students who are coming in with zero credits in some cases and coming in and only been for two years and there's some amazing work that schools are doing

[02:34:00] to support them but yet at the same time then they're being counted against them and i have real concern about that and so that's why i think the shall part is important and i do think if we if we talk about this the right way, if we resource it in the right way, which is why I talked earlier about the English learners by levels, because when you're SLIFE students, you're level one, there's some additional resources that are needed. So we talk about it the right way, when we resource the right way, when we put policies like this in place, I actually think we incentivize schools and divisions to really look differently at this population and to support them in a very, very targeted and differentiated way. So I appreciate the work you've done and I

[02:34:37] I appreciate my colleagues considering my amendment here. - So any other questions or comments? So I'll turn the question, any concerns with the recommendation that's here in terms of how the staff then continues to move forward?

[02:34:53] Any concerns with our continuing along this path? Hey, Dr. Sayle, I don't see any. So that brings us to the next section of equity. - Okay, wonderful. As I noted before, this is really kind of a companion piece to that access to academic rigor and school discipline disproportionality data in order for us to better understand practices and what's happening at the school and division level and to make informed

decisions about how to promote better practices and support divisions and their continuous improvement.

[02:35:28] Quality data is a key component of that. We know data collection is no small task and schools and divisions are asked to provide a lot. So this proposal would require them to develop a plan to improve those components of data collection.

[02:35:43] So kind of promoting an intentionality to make sure that the information that they're providing us is true and accurate and is really gonna be informative for next stages of any policy discussion in this space. The way that this particular language is designed is obviously we know at the forefront of conversation for us at this moment are those academic rigor pieces and disproportionality.

[02:36:05] but that might not always be the case. And so making sure that the language is designed, that there may be other expectations or other pieces of data that will be a key part of the conversation that we need to understand. And so these plans may evolve and may need to be adapted and the board will have the discretion and the ability to make those adjustments and a detailed guidance document about what these plans would entail.

[02:36:30] But where this is included is actually, if you recall, and the prerequisites for accreditation. So this is an expectation that school divisions produce these plans even prior to be awarding their accreditation rating. So this does give a little bit of gravity and weight to this requirement, that it's not just a box to check, that it's something that we genuinely want and value school divisions doing and making sure that they're completing these.

[02:36:55] So again, that translates to better, higher quality data for us as we make policy decisions supporting all of our learners and what they need moving forward there's a few different ways that schools can be compliant with this requirement so as we know our accreditation model is on a school basis schools as individuals can produce these plans and include them in their school level comprehensive plan but schools can also be considered compliant by virtue of their division having created a plan we know on things like data collection individual schools and central office staff work hand-in-hand on those components so wanted to provide that flexibility and reflect that local dynamic and how a school can

[02:37:35] be compliant for this requirement. I will pause there since this again this is another substantive one and we do have another leg of this conversation but if it might be worthwhile to tackle this one separately and individually we can certainly stop here or we can charge ahead and have this discussion as part of the other conversations on some of the outstanding substantive edits here today.

[02:37:58] Ms. Holton? Ms. So thank you. I get what we're aiming at here around data collection, but I'm a little confused. The headline is Plans to Improve Equity Outcomes. The language, both on the slide and in the red line document, is Plan to Improve Data Collection Around Equity

[02:38:30] outcomes and that is a distinction and what i'm not remembering frankly is do we already mandate in the soas a plan to improve equity outcomes and so a focus on the data collection in support thereof would be appropriate or if we don't already i i actually thought we were talking about mandating a plan for to improve equity outcomes in which case the data collection component of it would be one piece but not the whole so and I think the abbreviated title

[02:39:07] of the slide is probably miscaptures what what we intend from these the plans because of course a goal of schools and divisions should be how how we're serving all learners and thinking about in

their comprehensive plans they should be thinking about the services and provisions there so I think this is a little bit more nuanced and targeted and what we're trying to accomplish here in making sure that the data collection piece of this is also well-developed and intentional and high-quality data.

[02:39:34] So it is informing both their comprehensive plan and informing policy-based changes at the local level and things that we do here through the standards of accreditation. So this is more specific to the data collection piece than just improving equity outcomes. So that title is a bit of a misnomer and we can... Okay, but then am I right then there is not already a SOA requirement on the Pre-accreditation certification process of a plan to improve equity outcomes more globally Then I then I do think we need to figure out which we had in mind. I think this came out of our presentation from the African-American equity task for superintendents task force

[02:40:14] And I actually thought we, I understand that the data is the first step that we're wanting to nudge the divisions on. But I thought that we were trying to get them to a plan to improve. In other words, get the data and then look at it and do something with it is what, have a plan at least to do something with it.

[02:40:37] I thought that was where we were heading. Dr. Mann and then Dr. Roberts. thank you for your question um because i was thinking along the same lines i had the same point of of conflict or confusion over what we were after and i guess as i was considering uh what we were going to invite schools to share as evidence of being compliant i i immediately thought about it's great to have a district-wide plan but if the school is going to use that

[02:41:11] talking about how they are actually carrying out some fashion of that plan that connects to what the district is trying to accomplish to speak to their progress to speak to what they're actually doing because i i too worried that a plan absent what are we doing and and not not not forcing uniformity around how schools are addressing their desired outcomes in the space but certainly that there was some expectation that we were driving at outcomes around equity and not having a plan alone suffice as, you know, being adequate to address some of what

[02:41:50] I thought I too heard as this issue was being elevated in the various workshop conversations that we've had. MS. Dr. Robertson and then Dr. Lane. MR. Yeah, maybe Dr. Lane is going to answer the question or provide greater clarity.

[02:42:05] I'm not seeking an answer to the question right now, but I think that the second bullet regarding more to bed will develop more detailed guidance on what must be included in the plans. If we could have a glimpse of what that detailed guidance might be contemplated to be already, that would probably aid our conversation as long as this conversation goes, but I really don't want to know what the details are right now.

[02:42:31] Okay. Yeah. Thank you all three for the questions. what I'm going to take an opportunity to do here is say this slide in a different way. I think what we're saying here is we don't think you have to put this requirement into the SOA.

[02:42:46] We think that school divisions already, and schools, already have a requirement that they have school improvement plans and division-wide plans. And so what we're saying is rather than putting this into the SOA, we recommend that you instead develop guidance on what has to be in those plans so that you can clearly detail the equity outcomes you want them to address and the details that Dr. Robertson

was suggesting we're not we're not necessarily ready to propose those today but that's the that's the methodology we want to use partly because we believe that creating a requirement around a second plan is you

[02:43:23] know another thing that they have to do when really they should be doing this while they're going through their strategic planning process and their school improvement planning process and so it's it's more of a movement towards where we want to go, because you already have the requirement that they have to do these plans.

[02:43:41] Now you can be more detailed on what you want in it. So you mean when you say we already have the requirement, you mean this is a recommended new language to add to the SOA? So you mean the... Right.

[02:43:57] Well, essentially, school divisions already have the requirement they do division-wide planning and school planning. That's already in the requirements. Now what we're saying is we're going to use the guidance mechanism to really drive more of what we want, other than, you know, the reference to this and this. So does the requirement for school improvement plans that already exist before this revision, does it specify that those plans address how the division plans to improve outcome equity?

[02:44:33] It does not now. That's where this language will allow you to develop more guidance. Yeah. Well, if it doesn't already, then this does not meet my need. Because all this says is you have to have a plan for how you're going to collect data. You can collect data. You can have a plan to collect data that shows you're doing a disastrous job on equitable outcomes and have met this requirement.

[02:44:56] As long as you're collecting the data really, really well, You don't have to do a daggone thing in response to the data to satisfy this requirement. And that's where the second really digs in. No, no, because to me, the second bullet is just going to provide more guidance on what kind of data you need to collect.

[02:45:17] It doesn't set the goal of a plan to address equitable outcomes. And it may be that our, maybe we need to go back and look at the language around school improvement plans that are already required generally maybe it does require maybe those school improvement clients do have to address what are you gonna do about inequitable outcomes and so just getting them better data to work with will well is all that we need to add but I don't if the school improvement plan if one of the I hear you not wanting to make a big new plan requirement but

[02:45:53] maybe revise the requirement for the school improvement plan maybe go look at that language and make sure that planning for how you're going to improve the outcome equity. Yeah. Yeah. So if you looked at item nine and the new item 10 on page 92 and somehow work or massage those two together, that may help satisfy part of what I hear Ms. Holton saying and what I hear Dr. Lane saying is coming.

[02:46:25] But right now the two are standing separately. And what I hear us saying is that they could stand together, one supporting the other. But as it is right now, it looks like a totally separate plan in item 10, with no clear expectation that there's an action coming behind the plan itself.

[02:46:45] Right. And so there ought to be a plan for how you're going to improve -- a plan to improve equity outcomes, part of which is developing better data collection. But that's only part of it.

[02:47:01] And I agree with Dr. Wilson's suggestion that it may well be in Section 9, if that Section 9 is the comprehensive school plan requirement, if that's the only, you know, and I guess there are also school improvement plans required as part of the accreditation process, but I'm not sure that that's for everybody. That's only for those who have been identified as weaknesses.

[02:47:30] so this comprehensive plan is for is the only plan that's for everybody we'll strengthen the language i understand what you want dr man yeah no i i was i was going to add that i i would i would feel even better if we weren't dictating what it meant for a district to articulate their plans for improvement um because i do feel like oftentimes that does lead to get it done check the box but the idea that if within the comprehensive plan you are inviting people to talk about

[02:48:02] how they are going to improve outcomes then you you have a way that feels authentic to what a district is striving to accomplish and i'm i feel that that's much more meaningful than for the board to prescribe every district looks the same in terms of what and how it goes at this issue because the issue looks different across the Commonwealth.

[02:48:27] So I err in that direction versus feeling like we have to prescribe something that does become a formulaic activity to sort of check a box and get done. Other comments?

[02:48:46] So directionally, so that the staff knows how to move. I'm sorry, Dr. Anderson, before I do that, any comments or questions, suggestions there? yeah i i would just um i would say yes to both comments that were just made and i feel like there's like a a medium between the two because i do believe that established at least establishing some sort of footprint or template or um bounds of expectations as far as what a plan should include

[02:49:19] gives it some structure but then giving a school its own authentic flexibility to the to to craft what works for them i you know i think there's a a happy medium so i'm i'm just sitting back listening to the discussion and i'm and i'm watching you guys i can see you you can only look wonderful by the way but uh i'm back watching and listening and i just i just kind of i hear something in the middle that it resonates more with me but that's all i would offer thank you

[02:49:53] thank you so then uh go ahead dr lane i'm good go ahead okay so directionally um as staff then is working. Is there consensus that this idea of a plan that focuses on improved outcomes is a direction that we want to head, knowing that there's still some work to do with language and how we fit this expectation within a frame that already exists, perhaps, or make it more clear in terms of what it is we'd like to see? Do we have consensus for staff to know that they

[02:50:31] should continue in this direction. Any concerns? I don't see any, Dr. Sale. Put a period. Next paragraph. Well, I have all of that noted here, that we can revise and massage that language to reflect a broader plan here and figure out the framework for compliance for that piece.

[02:50:52] Great. Okay. All right. So you want to talk about, oh, the implementation committee. Sure. Um, these last few substantive edits are the result of conversations, um, from staff internally, um, which were in part informed by stakeholder feedback and feedback from divisions, but also, um, just as we've had the opportunity to observe implementation over the last few years, um, recognize needs, um, and maybe making some edits to, to support our students and schools and divisions, um, in their work around the standards of accreditation.

[02:51:26] So in addition to the technical amendments that are included in the document and the items that we've noted related to Dislife and the equity plans there are a few other blue items that we considered substantive edits that work are coming from the SMI Implementation committee. I think as a scale goes These are a bit smaller than those two other items that we had kind of broken out as part of the discussion But still a shift in policy change and thinking that was meaningful enough that we thought It was important for us to pull these out and note these for the board and um the first one is a language change around setting an expectation for promotion of english

[02:52:02] language students um and just to clarify here um while i think the expectation is implicit in our standards of accreditation document um this clearly marks that that no english language or english learner student um should be held back a grade solely based on their language proficiency so making sure that that expectation is clear and explicitly set out in the board standards of accreditation we added the options for a verified credit in history and social science based on the new appropriation language that does give us a little bit of flexibility for for the use of performance assessments so making sure that that is now carried over and reflected in the standards of

[02:52:38] accreditation documents which did require edits in a few places including graduation requirements where we break out the way a student can earn a verified credit as well as a itemized section of the document which focuses on standard and verified units of credit.

[02:52:53] We did update language on performance assessments, which again, I think were understood implicitly by the board to be how we want and understand the implementation of performance assessments to work. But it was clarifying language around that better aligns with practice in the field related to the use of the word authentic and the pluralization of performance assessments.

[02:53:13] We understood the board to expect and want schools and divisions using performance assessments in writing to have to have multiple checkpoints in order for those to satisfy the verified credit requirements so making sure that that's reflected there in our graduation requirements section we do propose a new diploma seal and fine arts so making sure those students who are successful and interested and thriving and those fine arts disciplines have an opportunity to show that success and be recognized for that in our transfer student section we made a change on on which courses, or rather, which assessments can be used to apply towards verified credits

[02:53:53] when they transferred into a Virginia public school. This is primarily focusing on those schools who are those transfer students who are late entry, who don't have the opportunity to take all the SOL coursework or end of course assessments to get them to the verified credit requirement. So they would be able to use any end of course or exit assessment in their previous state or home state and expands that as it was formally limited to those tests that were used for graduation.

[02:54:19] So if they've been tested and shown mastery of content in their home state, that would translate to a verified credit in Virginia. The language around remediation and mathematics. In the standards of accreditation, we do have very explicit language around when we intervene and provide remedial services for reading.

[02:54:38] The same language was not mirrored for mathematics. So making sure the expectation for school divisions was we were promoting literacy and fluency and numeracy. well so carrying that language there a part of this also clarifies for school divisions that the expectation is that these services are provided outside of core instructional time and outside of the normal classroom experience to make sure that these

are supplemental and complementary resources available to students and lastly is the requirement for schools to develop and maintain a data security plan I know this is a little bit confusing based on our last discussion and where this would fit into the standards of accreditation this

[02:55:17] would not be part of the prerequisites for accreditation or whatever format the previous previous proposal will take but this is a requirement for school facilities and safety so as we transition to increasing uses of virtual and remote environments the the ability to exchange data and information across schools and students and parents is becoming more vital and more necessary and so making sure that there are kind of safety mechanisms in place so that data and information squarely meets federal and state laws for privacy, but also that

[02:55:55] best practices are used to ensure the safety of that information and data exchange. Quickly before we jump into the discussion around those last few substantive items, just to note so we can look forward, the hope and that the special committee will have an opportunity to finalize these proposed changes the next time we convene as a group in September, which would mean the following month in October of 2021, your committee would be able to bring to the full board your complete recommendation package, which includes what we have here in addition to those revised components that we'll bring back in September, and then the

[02:56:34] final review of the proposed stage being brought to the full board in November. So that would conclude your role in that first leg of regulatory action, which is the proposed phase before we embark on the next step of the work. So I will jump back to this slide because I think this is just the last outstanding item we have for decision points to make sure that these are things that the board understand and are comfortable with, or committee, rather, understand and are comfortable with as substantive edits to the standards of accreditation.

[02:57:04] Any comments or questions on these last seven bullets here? Not seeing any. Dr. Anderson? Yeah, I do have one comment.

[02:57:25] Just trying to read where we are in the presentation. I believe this was the last decision point. Is that correct? that is correct yeah um now that's what we just heard i don't need any comments respective to that but uh i just overall just with all the recommendations that have been formally uh presented and organized for us to understand and consider today um i just thought it would be a good time for the committee members and for even some of the members that maybe weren't

[02:58:02] with us when we first started them spiritually um they didn't get the opportunity to participate in my over-engineered approach to uh like establishing a committee working plan and kind of taking a mission analysis approach to understanding what's our objective you know what's our assumptions and facts and considerations and you know but i only bring that up for one reason not to not to drug everybody back through it again by any means but the one objective that we settled on to kind of write our course well to write our course again for us to uh this committee was going

[02:58:41] to conduct a review of a newly and newly implemented accreditation system the newly implemented accreditation system to assess uh there's three things we remember it was the anticipated positive negative and unintended outcomes um of of the of the uh of the system that was put in place and we we also agreed to validate yes that we're making efficient progress towards what are our positive and outcomes intended outcomes were so i just use that as a

[02:59:18] barometer or something for us to measure these these um these changes some of these changes are just you know technical in nature that they mean it's relative to other regulatory acting and things that are influencing it but for some of the other ones that i think are very creative and very timely uh we just want to continue to make sure we're holding ourselves accountable to our original focus and our original objective but i think uh all of these recommendations um uh do support uh

[02:59:52] positive and or what we want to maybe correct some unintended outcomes so that's all i want to offer thank you dr anderson and we we appreciate your highly over highly and overly engineered work plan it in fact has gotten us to this point and so i'd like to thank dr sale and the rest of the staff for all of the work to put together this set of recommendations dr sale i think you have a sense of where this committee and other members of the board would like to see land and we have the outline of the time timeline as it's in front of us.

[03:00:29] And so on behalf of Dr. Anderson, thank you all very much for your participation in this afternoon's committee meeting. We'll convene tomorrow morning for our regular business meeting at I believe 9:00 a.m., 9:00 a.m. Thank you.

[03:00:45] Have a great afternoon. Thank you.

